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FROM COMPLIANCE TO TRANSFORMATION: FACULTY PERSPECTIVES ON AI-DRIVEN PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

A Dissertation Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the
Requirements for the Degree
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in
Organizational Leadership

Reyna Trujillo

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ABSTRACT

Purpose. This qualitative study investigated faculty perceptions of AI-driven professional development (AI-PD) in higher education and how those perceptions influence teaching practice, ethical sensitivity, and institutional change. AI-PD is professional learning that is supported or shaped by AI and is conceptually distinct from AI-focused professional development, which involves teaching faculty about AI tools or their classroom integration. This distinction positions AI not as content, but as an active mechanism influencing how professional learning is designed, delivered, and experienced.

Theoretical Framework. The study drew upon the technology acceptance model, the unified theory of acceptance and use of technology, and transformative learning theory to examine the cognitive, affective, and ethical dimensions of technology adoption.

Methodology. Using a one-phase interpretivist design, the study employed 18 open-ended interview questions with faculty in the Los Angeles Community College District, conducted through a secure online platform with optional follow-up conversation (N = 10).

Findings and Conclusion. Thematic analysis revealed that faculty experiences with AI-PD exist on a continuum ranging from compliance-based participation to transformative and reflexive engagement. Adoption was influenced not only by perceived usefulness, ease of use, and institutional support, but also by trust, autonomy, and alignment with human-centered values such as empathy, equity, and creativity. Although participants expressed concerns regarding workload misconceptions, privacy, bias, and transparency, many also demonstrated a cautious form of techno-optimism that AI, when implemented ethically and collaboratively, can enhance teaching, learning, and professional growth. When AI-PD was contextualized, supported by transparent communication, and embedded within protected time for reflection and experimentation, faculty reported meaningful shifts in assessment design, instructional innovation, and student support practices. These findings extend existing technology acceptance theories by emphasizing the role of ethical awareness, affective readiness, and emerging techno-optimistic orientations in professional learning environments.

Recommendations. The study offers practical recommendations for institutional leaders seeking to design supportive, transparent, and faculty-driven AI-enabled professional development systems that move beyond compliance toward sustainable transformation. Implications highlight the importance of collaborative governance, ongoing evaluation, and equitable access to resources in ensuring that AI-enabled professional development strengthens faculty agency, promotes student success, and contributes to organizational learning across diverse educational contexts.

CONTENTS

Page

ABSTRACT iv

FIGURES xi

TABLES xii

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS xiii

DEDICATION xv

CHAPTER

I. INTRODUCTION 1

Background 1

Problem Statement 2

Purpose Statement 4

Theoretical Framework 4

Research Questions 6

Significance of the Study 7

Definition of Terms 9

Delimitations of the Study 13

Summary 15

II. LITERATURE REVIEW 16

Overview of AI in Higher Learning Institutions 16

AI Tools in Higher Education 16

Functional Applications 17

Data-Driven Decisions 17

AI in Faculty Professional Development 18
From Compliance to Transformation 18
Benefits of AI for Faculty Development 19
Challenges to Adoption and Implementation 19
Innovative Models and Practical Applications 20
Theoretical Foundations 21
TAM 22
UTAUT and UTAUT2 22
Affective Acceptance and Ethical Awareness 22
Integrated Theoretical Model 22
Reflexivity and Theoretical Positioning 22
Gaps in the Literature 23
Ethical and Human-Centered Considerations 23
Privacy, Bias, and Transparency 23
Faculty Responsibility and Trust 24
Inclusion and Digital Access 24
Multidisciplinary Collaboration and Global Perspectives 24
Cross-Disciplinary Integration Needed 24
Global Adoption Differences 25
Collaborative Ethical Governance 25
Bridging Literature Gaps 26
Summary 27
III. METHODOLOGY 29

Research Design 29
Site of the Study and Rationale 32
Data Collection 34
Data Analysis 34
Research Quality Assurance 35
Researcher Positionality and Reflexivity 35
Limitations 36
Summary 37
IV. FINDINGS 39
Purpose of the Study 39
Research Questions 40
Participant Selection 40
Participant Profile 40
Interview Structure 41
Findings 42
RQ1: Faculty Experiences of AI-Driven Professional Development .. 42
Professional Development Driven by AI Is on a Spectrum Between Compliance and Transformation 42
Compliance-Driven AI-PD as Institutional Obligation 43
Transformative AI-PD as Reflective and Practice-Based Learning 44
RQ2: Misconceptions and Knowledge Gaps 46
Faculty Motivation Toward AI-PD Is Conditional and Not Attitudinal 46

Time, Workload, and Scheduling as Structural Barriers 47
Clarity and Communication Shape Readiness 47
RQ3: Attitudes, Participation, and Resistance 48
Faculty Approach to AI in Different Contexts: Instructional Innovation and Academic Integrity 48
Instructional Innovation Orientation 48
Academic Integrity Orientation 49
RQ4: Teaching Practices and Student Outcomes 49
Human-Centered Values Are a Limit to AI Acceptance 50
Student Support and Alignment Through Accessibility 50
Misalignment by Dehumanization or Standardization 51
RQ5: Congruency With the Human-Centered Values 52
Ethical Concerns Are Trust Conditions and Not Absolute Principles 52
Privacy, Bias, and Transparency as Preconditions of Engagement 53
Institutional Intent Influences Ethical Comfort 53
RQ6: Faculty Confidence and Support Needed 53
Faculty Define Effective AI-PD as Co-Designed, Supported, and Iterative 54
Agency and Choice Facilitate Engagement 54
Structural Supports Signal Institutional Commitment 54
Faculty Voice in Institutional AI Decision-Making Empowers Trust 55

RQ7: Ethical Concerns and Recommendations 55
RQ8: Faculty Perceptions of Professional Agency, Autonomy, and Transformative Capacity in AI-Driven Professional Development 56
AI-Driven Professional Development as Either Empowerment or Encroachment 57
Professional Agency as Conditional and Context Dependent 57
Transformative Capacity Rooted in Reflective Authority 58
Concerns Regarding Surveillance and Professional Identity 59
Synthesis of Findings 59
RQ9: Partnerships and Institutional Implications 60
Cross-Cutting Insights 61
Interrelationships Among Themes 61
Summary 62
V. SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS 64
Key Findings 64
AI-Driven PD as Transformative or Transactional 64
Misconceptions, Readiness, and Affective Factors 65
Human-Centered Values and Ethical Awareness 66
Faculty Agency and Institutional Dynamics 67
Institutional Partnerships and Systemic Change 68
Discussion 69
Implications 70
Extension of Technology Acceptance Models 71

Transformative Learning as Conditional 71
Implications for Practice 72
Ethics, Equity, and Trust 72
Leadership and Policy Implications 73
Implications for Future Research 74
Limitations 74
Recommendations for Future Research 75
Recommendations for Institutions 75
Faculty Developer and Practitioner Recommendations 77
Practice and Future Research Recommendations 78
Summary 78
REFERENCES 80
APPENDICES 87
A. FACULTY INTERVIEW PROTOCOL 88
B. CONSENT TO PARTICIPATE IN RESEARCH FORM 93
C. RECRUITMENT COMMUNICATIONS 103
D. IRB APPLICATIONS 107
E. DATA SECURITY AND RETENTION STATEMENT 109
F. FINAL CODEBOOK (VERSION 2) 111
G. UNCODING 122
H. IRB EXEMPTION LETTER 129

FIGURES

Figure Page

1. Conceptual Framework for Faculty Perceptions of AI-Driven PD..... 27

2. Research Process Flow Diagram 31

3. Conceptual Framework for AI-Driven Professional Development 32

TABLES

Table Page

1. Survey Sections, Research Questions, Themes, and Deliverables 33

2. Summary of Final Themes and Their Alignment With Research Questions 63

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and the honor of this milestone. I am not the last. This achievement is not an ending but a beginning.

I look forward to witnessing the continued rise of our family for generations to come.

DEDICATION

This dissertation is dedicated to faculty, those who continue to show up, question, adapt, and lead in times of uncertainty. Your resilience, ethical courage, and commitment to students and communities are the foundation of meaningful change in education. It is also dedicated to the districts, institutions, and leaders who are willing to be vulnerable, open minded, and reflective as artificial intelligence reshapes our educational systems. Your willingness to engage in difficult conversations, challenge existing structures, and move toward more human-centered, ethical, and collaborative approaches makes this work possible. Finally, this work is dedicated to my children and my family, the reason I kept going when the path felt heavy and uncertain. Your patience, your love, and your belief in me carried me through every challenge. As a first-generation Mexicana earning this doctorate, I carry our story with pride. I may be the first, but I will not be the last.
I look forward to the continued rise of our family for generations to come.

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

Background

Artificial intelligence (AI) is rapidly reshaping higher education by transforming how faculty teach, how students learn, and how institutions design professional development (PD). For this study, it is important to distinguish between AI-focused professional development and AI-driven professional development (AI-PD). *AI-focused PD* refers to initiatives that teach faculty about artificial intelligence tools and their integration into teaching, learning, or assessment. In contrast, *AI-driven PD* refers to professional learning experiences that are shaped, supported, or enhanced by AI technologies themselves, such as adaptive learning platforms, automated feedback systems, chatbots, or predictive analytics. This distinction positions AI not simply as content to be learned but as an active mechanism influencing how professional development is designed, delivered, and experienced. Although traditional PD has long emphasized compliance-driven participation and seat-time metrics, these approaches increasingly have been criticized as insufficient for meaningful faculty growth. Guskey (2021) argued that effective PD should be evaluated based on its impact on instructional practice and student learning rather than attendance alone.

The emergence of AI-driven PD introduces new possibilities for responsiveness, personalization, and the integration of data-driven insights, while also raising questions of ethics, agency, and equity. Institutions are increasingly using AI not only in

classrooms but also to support faculty professional growth. Examples include adaptive PD platforms that personalize learning goals, AI tutors that guide skill development, and analytics dashboards that help educators reflect on their teaching effectiveness (Gligorea et al., 2023). Automated feedback systems and chatbots streamline administrative tasks, freeing time for deeper learning (Bond et al., 2024). These developments suggest that AI can make PD more personalized, responsive, and scalable. As institutions have experimented with AI-enabled professional development, faculty responses have ranged from skepticism and concern to cautious techno-optimism—the belief that emerging technologies can enhance teaching and professional learning when implemented ethically and with institutional support.

However, the rapid integration of AI raises a fundamental tension: Will AI-driven PD reinforce compliance-driven models or foster transformative, faculty-centered learning? As colleges expand AI-enabled PD, faculty face increasing expectations to develop digital literacy, ethical awareness, and adaptive competence (Al Samman, 2024). Professional development is no longer optional; it is essential for academic resilience and relevance in a technology-driven era. Understanding how faculty perceive and experience these changes is vital to ensuring that professional development evolves beyond compliance checklists toward authentic, human-centered growth. This study explored these perceptions through the voices of faculty themselves, emphasizing how AI-driven PD shapes engagement, instructional practice, and professional identity.

Problem Statement

Persistent inequities in access to digital resources and professional development remain barriers for faculty, particularly in under-resourced institutions. AI-driven PD is

often promoted as an innovative solution, yet, as Selwyn (2019) has cautioned, techno-optimism can obscure critical concerns about power, autonomy, and the relational dimensions of teaching. Faculty may resist AI tools not solely because of technical limitations but also due to issues of identity, trust, and institutional culture (Nelson, 2024). The problem addressed by this study is the lack of research capturing how faculty themselves describe their experiences with AI-driven professional development, particularly how they connect perceptions of usefulness and effectiveness with human-centered values, teaching practices, and student outcomes. Although AI tools are increasingly used for content delivery, assessment, and feedback, there is little evidence on how such tools reshape pedagogy or influence faculty engagement (Chen et al., 2020). Without this understanding, institutions cannot determine whether AI-driven PD achieves its intended goal of improving teaching and learning (McGrath et al., 2023).

Moreover, the ethical, emotional, and contextual dimensions of AI-driven PD remain underexplored. Concerns about data privacy, professional autonomy, and equity seldom have been addressed in the literature (Bond et al., 2024). Faculty engagement with AI is shaped not only by its technical function but also by trust, professional identity, and institutional culture (Nelson, 2024). These gaps highlight the need for qualitative research that centers faculty voice and examines how educators experience AI-driven PD technologically, pedagogically, and affectively. This study addressed that need through open-ended qualitative interviews, completed through either Google Forms or optional one-on-one sessions, to capture authentic narratives about how AI-driven PD influences professional growth, ethics, and transformation.

Purpose Statement

The purpose of this qualitative study was to explore how higher-education faculty perceive AI-driven PD and how these perceptions shape engagement, teaching practices, and support for student success. Grounded in the technology acceptance model (TAM), the unified theory of acceptance and use of technology (UTAUT2), transformative learning theory, and ethical-affective constructs, the study centered faculty voices and human-centered values (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). Methodologically, it employed a single-phase qualitative interview design involving 18 open-ended questions completed by faculty across the Los Angeles Community College District (LACCD). Participants could choose to complete the written interview via Google Forms or participate in an optional one-on-one interview (Zoom or in person). The study was designed to generate insights for both scholarship and practice, offering actionable guidance for the development of ethical, effective, and human-centered professional development that meaningfully integrates artificial intelligence while preserving faculty agency and trust.

Theoretical Framework

This study integrated the TAM, the UTAUT2, and extensions emphasizing ethical awareness and affective acceptance (Davis, 1989; de Blanes Sebastián et al., 2022; McGrath et al., 2023; Venkatesh, 2022). These models are complemented by transformative learning theory and principles of adult learning, situating AI-driven PD within faculty-centered and humanistic traditions (Knowles, 1980; Knowles et al., 2015; Mezirow, 1991, 2000). The foundation of the framework is the TAM, which posits that technology adoption is shaped by two primary perceptions: usefulness and ease of use. Faculty are more likely to engage with AI-driven PD when they believe it enhances their

teaching effectiveness and can be integrated without undue complexity (Weibe, 2024). Building on TAM, the UTAUT2 expands the model to include social influence, facilitating conditions, and motivational factors such as enjoyment and habit (Acosta-Enriquez et al., 2024). In higher education, these factors include institutional support, peer collaboration, access to resources, and alignment with daily teaching practices. Together, TAM and UTAUT2 provide a foundation for understanding the cognitive and behavioral dimensions of how faculty perceive and adopt AI-related PD.

However, adoption alone does not capture the full scope of faculty experiences. Engagement with AI-driven PD also reflects ethical, emotional, and identity-based considerations. As Kelly et al. (2023) argued, trust, fairness, and transparency strongly influence acceptance of AI in education. Similarly, McGrath et al. (2023) highlighted how autonomy, professional identity, and responsibility shape faculty engagement. These dimensions extend beyond usability to encompass whether AI-driven PD aligns with faculty members' values of empathy, equity, and creativity, as well as their sense of professional agency. Accordingly, ethical-affective factors are integrated as a core dimension of the framework.

Finally, the framework draws from transformative learning theory, which emphasizes critical reflection, perspective transformation, and the movement from compliance-driven training toward authentic professional growth. This lens underscores how AI-driven PD can either perpetuate institutional compliance cultures or catalyze faculty-centered transformation through reflection and dialogue. By integrating TAM, UTAUT2, ethical-affective constructs, and transformative learning theory, this framework provides a comprehensive lens for examining faculty perceptions of AI-driven

PD. It guided the design of the Faculty Interview Protocol (Sections A–E), ensuring that questions addressed both technical and human-centered dimensions. The framework also informed the coding and interpretation of faculty narratives, allowing the study to illuminate how cognition, ethics, and transformation intersect in faculty engagement with AI-driven professional development.

Research Questions

Guided by the purpose of this study, the research questions explored how higher-education faculty perceive and experience AI-driven PD, specifically its usefulness, effectiveness, alignment with human-centered values, and influence on teaching practice, student support, and institutional pathways toward transformative learning.

One primary research question directed the study: How do higher-education faculty describe their experiences and perceptions of AI-driven professional development in terms of usefulness, effectiveness, and alignment with human-centered values, and in what ways do these perceptions shape their teaching practices, student support, and institutional pathways toward transformative learning?

Nine subquestions supported the primary research question:

1. What themes emerge from faculty experiences with AI-driven PD, and how do these connect to theories of transformative learning?
2. What misconceptions or knowledge gaps do faculty express about AI-driven PD, and how do these shape engagement or resistance?
3. How do faculty describe their attitudes, participation, or reluctance toward AI-driven PD, and what does this reveal about readiness for learning beyond compliance-driven PD?

4. In what ways do faculty perceive AI-driven PD as influencing their teaching practices and student outcomes?
5. How do faculty view AI-driven PD as supporting or conflicting with human-centered teaching values such as empathy, equity, creativity, and relational engagement?
6. How do faculty describe their confidence in critically assessing AI tools, and what supports do they identify as necessary for meaningful and ethical use?
7. What ethical concerns, such as privacy, bias, or transparency, do faculty raise regarding AI-driven PD, and what strategies do they suggest for addressing them?
8. How do faculty perceive AI-driven PD as shaping their professional agency, autonomy, and capacity for transformative practice?
9. How do faculty believe their perspectives on AI-driven PD could inform institutional policies, PD design, or faculty-district partnerships?

Significance of the Study

This study holds significance for both scholarship and institutional practice. For researchers, it advances adoption models by embedding ethical, affective, and identity-related dimensions (Nelson, 2024). For practitioners, it highlights how PD must move beyond compliance to become transformative, aligning with Guskey's (2021) call to link PD to actual teaching and learning changes. As O'Meara et al. (2020) argued, PD should not be confined to individuals but rather treated as organizational learning that shapes culture and policy. The findings offer practical strategies for institutions to co-design AI-driven PD that fosters equity, ethics, and sustainability. From a scholarly perspective, this

study extends existing frameworks such as TAM and UTAUT2 by integrating ethical, affective, and transformative learning lenses (Bond et al., 2024; McGrath et al., 2023). It contributes to the literature by highlighting how faculty perceptions of usefulness, ease of use, and institutional support are inseparable from values of trust, equity, and professional identity. In doing so, the study addresses a critical research gap in professional development scholarship, where faculty agency and human-centered values have often been marginalized in favor of technical or institutional metrics.

The study is also significant in addressing issues of equity and access. Professional development opportunities frequently privilege full-time faculty or high-resource programs, leaving adjunct, contingent, or noncredit instructors with fewer supports. By explicitly exploring whether AI-driven PD is perceived as equitable and relevant across different faculty groups, the study provides insights into how institutions can create inclusive PD systems that empower all educators. This focus ensures that the benefits of AI integration are distributed fairly, strengthening institutional commitments to diversity and equity. For institutional leaders, the findings offer actionable guidance for sustainable, future-ready PD systems. As colleges and universities face pressure to adopt AI responsibly, this study equips decision-makers with evidence on how faculty actually experience and evaluate AI-driven PD. Insights may support the design of PD policies and programs that not only foster innovation but also respect ethical responsibility, transparency, and faculty autonomy. In this way, the study contributes to strategic planning, policy formation, and resource allocation that aligns institutional goals with faculty expectations and needs.

For faculty, the study underscores the potential of AI-driven PD to promote authentic growth, agency, and confidence. By capturing narratives about readiness, misconceptions, ethical concerns, and long-term impact, the study highlights how PD can evolve from compliance-driven workshops to experiences that build AI literacy, pedagogical creativity, and professional empowerment. These findings may help faculty see their role not just as recipients of PD but as co-creators of professional learning pathways that are relevant, human centered, and transformative.

Finally, this study is significant because it directly aligns with its research questions, which investigate effectiveness, ethics, equity, agency, and long-term impact. By doing so, it provides a holistic account of faculty engagement with AI-driven PD that can inform both day-to-day teaching practices and institutional strategy. Ultimately, this research sought to generate insights that are not only academically rigorous but also practically meaningful, creating a roadmap for higher education systems to leverage AI while honoring the human dimensions of teaching and learning.

Definition of Terms

Affective acceptance: The emotional dimension of faculty attitudes toward AI and AI-related PD, including curiosity, enthusiasm, anxiety, or resistance. It represents how faculty feel about engaging with AI as part of their professional roles.

Agency: The capacity of faculty to act with autonomy, choice, and self-direction in their professional learning and instructional decisions. In the context of AI-driven PD, *agency* refers to the extent to which faculty feel empowered to engage with AI tools on their own terms rather than through compliance mandates.

AI-driven professional development: Structured professional learning activities for faculty that are supported or enhanced by AI technologies, such as adaptive learning systems, chatbots, automated feedback, and predictive analytics.

AI-focused professional development: Faculty-development initiatives specifically designed to help educators understand AI technologies and explore methods for integrating AI tools into curriculum, instruction, or assessment.

AI literacy: The ability to understand, use, and critically evaluate AI tools responsibly. This includes awareness of ethical issues such as bias, transparency, and privacy, as well as the pedagogical capacity to integrate AI effectively in teaching and learning.

Andragogy: An adult-learning theory emphasizing autonomy, experience, and problem-centered learning (Knowles, 1980). In this study, andragogy reflects the need for PD that values faculty experience and promotes relevance, reflection, and self-direction.

Compliance-driven PD: Professional development is primarily required for institutional accountability or policy compliance, emphasizing completion rather than meaningful faculty growth.

Equity in PD: Fair and inclusive distribution of PD opportunities across all faculty groups, whether adjunct, contingent, full-time, or noncredit, ensuring equal access to innovation and institutional support.

Ethical awareness: Faculty capacity to recognize, reflect on, and respond to the ethical implications of AI use in teaching and PD, including privacy, bias, transparency, fairness, and academic integrity.

Faculty agency: The ability of faculty to exercise professional judgment and autonomy in PD participation and instructional practice, examined here in relation to whether AI-driven PD empowers or constrains faculty growth.

Faculty development (general PD): Structured initiatives intended to improve faculty knowledge, pedagogical skills, and professional growth, including workshops or training sessions not necessarily linked to AI.

Heutagogy: A self-determined learning model that builds on andragogy by focusing on learner agency, capability, and adaptability in complex environments (Hase & Kenyon, 2000). Within this study, heutagogy represents the potential of AI-driven PD to empower faculty as co-creators of their learning rather than passive recipients of training.

Human-centered values: Core teaching values such as empathy, equity, creativity, and relational engagement anchor ethical and learner-focused practice. In this study, the term refers to how well AI-driven PD aligns with these guiding values.

Institutional support: The leadership, culture, and resources that enable or hinder faculty participation in PD, including workload considerations, incentives, and technology access.

Pedagogy: A teacher-directed approach to learning emphasizing structured instruction, where learners depend on the educator for knowledge and guidance. Within this study, pedagogy represents compliance-based or content-driven professional-development models.

Perceived ethicality: Faculty perceptions of the fairness, transparency, and responsibility underlying AI-driven PD and AI use in education (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023).

Student success: The achievement of desired learning outcomes and holistic student growth, which is fostered by effective teaching and faculty professional learning.

TAM: A model explaining how perceived usefulness and ease of use influence willingness to adopt new technologies in educational settings (Davis, 1989; Weibe, 2024).

Techno-optimism: Refers to the belief that technological innovation, when implemented responsibly and ethically, has the potential to improve human systems, practices, and outcomes. In the context of this study, *techno-optimism* describes faculty perspectives that view artificial intelligence not merely as a compliance requirement or institutional mandate but as a tool that can enhance teaching practice, professional learning, and student support when aligned with human-centered values such as transparency, equity, creativity, and academic autonomy.

Transformative learning: A process of critical reflection through which educators question and revise their assumptions, values, and professional practices. In this study, *transformative learning* refers to shifts in pedagogical identity and approach prompted by engagement with AI-driven PD.

UTAUT2: An extended technology-adoption framework incorporating social influence, facilitating conditions, hedonic motivation, and behavioral intention to explain technology acceptance in contexts such as AI in higher education (Acosta-Enriquez et al., 2024; Venkatesh, 2022).

Delimitations of the Study

This study operated under several assumptions consistent with qualitative research and its focus on faculty perspectives. It was assumed that faculty participants would share truthful and thoughtful accounts of their experiences with AI-driven PD, even when those experiences included uncertainty, skepticism, or resistance. Their reflections were expected to illuminate not only the perceived usefulness and ease of AI tools but also the ways these tools intersect with the values of empathy, equity, creativity, and student-centered teaching.

Another assumption was that participating institutions have implemented, or are in the process of implementing, AI-enhanced PD initiatives with sufficient visibility for participants to provide substantive reflections. It was further assumed that though faculty experiences would be diverse, common themes would emerge revealing how AI-driven PD can serve as either a compliance mechanism or a pathway toward transformative growth. Finally, the study assumed that by elevating faculty voices, meaningful insights could be generated to inform institutional strategies and strengthen faculty-institution partnerships.

The study was delimited in several important ways. First, it focused exclusively on higher-education faculty, excluding K–12 educators, administrators, and staff. Within higher education, it was bound to institutions where AI is present in PD initiatives, either formally or informally, thereby excluding institutions without exposure to AI-related faculty development. The scope was further limited to professional development activities, not to broader institutional applications of AI such as admissions, advising, or student support systems. Geographically, the study was delimited to the LACCD, which

may affect transferability. Methodologically, the research employed a single-phase qualitative interview design, using written interviews administered via Google Forms and optional one-on-one interviews to capture depth and nuance. It did not seek large-scale generalizability but instead prioritized depth of understanding, centering faculty voices within a manageable and coherent scope.

Several limitations must also be acknowledged. Faculty experiences with AI-driven PD will inevitably vary depending on institutional context, available resources, and leadership support. Differences between well-resourced and under-resourced programs may influence how faculty perceive equity in PD opportunities. The reliance on self-reported, de-identified data presents another limitation, as responses may have been shaped by recall bias, social desirability, or limited familiarity with AI concepts. Though thematic analysis and reflexivity help mitigate these concerns, subjectivity remains inherent.

Researcher positionality is another limitation. As a scholar-practitioner within higher education, the researcher's interpretations may be influenced by personal experience. Reflexive journaling and ongoing consultation with the dissertation committee were used to minimize this bias. Finally, the rapid evolution of AI in education presents a temporal limitation: Findings represent a snapshot of faculty perceptions during a period of technological transition. They may shift as AI policies, ethics, and tools continue to evolve.

Taken together, these assumptions, delimitations, and limitations provide essential context for interpreting the study's findings. They define the boundaries of the research while reinforcing its value by situating faculty voices at the center of inquiry. These

considerations also underscore the study's potential contributions to institutional leaders seeking to bridge the gap between policy intentions and faculty realities, ensuring that AI-driven PD evolves as a meaningful, ethical, and human-centered practice rather than a compliance-driven requirement.

Summary

In summary, the assumptions, delimitations, and limitations outlined here define the scope and credibility of this study. While acknowledging its constraints, the research maintains strong potential to generate actionable insights into the evolving role of AI-driven professional development. Chapter II reviews the literature that informed this study, examining the technological, pedagogical, ethical, and human-centered dimensions of AI in higher education and professional development.

CHAPTER II

LITERATURE REVIEW

Overview of AI in Higher Learning Institutions

AI Tools in Higher Education

Although existing studies often have emphasized the technical efficiency of AI in teaching and learning, far fewer have examined how faculty experience AI as a transformative learning process that challenges assumptions, fosters reflection, and reshapes teaching practices. According to Chen et al. (2020), AI in higher education has become increasingly prevalent and effective in supporting instruction, evaluation, and decision-making. Four primary categories of AI tools are commonly identified: intelligent tutoring systems, chatbots, recommender systems, and predictive analytics platforms (Al Samman, 2024; Bayaga, 2025). Intelligent tutoring systems adapt to learners' needs in real time, offering individualized feedback that enhances performance (Al Samman, 2024). Chatbots, defined as automated conversational entities, assist with administrative queries and learning support, reducing routine workload for faculty (Nelson, 2024). Recommender systems within learning platforms suggest resources aligned with student progress and interests (G. M. et al., 2024). Predictive analytics draw on historical and real-time data to forecast student success and identify at-risk learners, guiding proactive interventions (Aithal et al., 2024). Taken together, these tools support more adaptive, responsive, and student-centered learning environments (Al Samman, 2024).

Functional Applications

AI technologies are embedded across multiple dimensions of higher education, including curriculum design, adaptive feedback, and assessment. AI supports curriculum development by aligning programs with labor-market demands and student learning preferences (Chen et al., 2020). It enables adaptive assessment with instant feedback to help learners master complex concepts more efficiently (Nelson, 2024). AI-driven grading tools streamline assessment in large classes, reduce bias, and allow faculty to focus on higher-order evaluation such as creativity, critical thinking, and discourse (Messer et al., 2024). AI systems also track attendance, engagement, and academic integrity, providing data for evidence-based instructional adjustments (Gligorea et al., 2023). These functional applications demonstrate how AI can enhance efficiency and responsiveness. At the same time, they reshape professional expectations, decision-making autonomy, and pedagogical identity issues, which this study examined through the lens of AI-driven professional development.

Data-Driven Decisions

A central promise of AI is enabling evidence-based decision-making at scale. Institutions increasingly employ AI to move from reactive to proactive management of teaching and learning (Rahiman & Kodikal, 2024). Faculty use real-time analytics to identify struggling students, adapt strategies, and monitor outcomes in a continuous feedback loop. Bond et al. (2024) emphasized that AI promotes continuous improvement by generating insights into both student achievement and instructional design. Rather than adhering to static curricula, AI-supported environments enable dynamic, data-informed pedagogy centered on learner needs. Institutionally, analytics platforms connect

departments, foster collaboration, and support strategic planning and cross-disciplinary innovation (George & Wooden, 2023). Although these capabilities offer new precision, they also introduce ethical questions about privacy, consent, and the role of human judgment. These considerations echo across AI-driven professional development, where data increasingly inform how faculty learning is evaluated and shaped.

AI in Faculty Professional Development

From Compliance to Transformation

Traditional PD in higher education has long been criticized for emphasizing seat time and attendance over meaningful changes in practice. Guskey (2021) argued that PD should be evaluated by its impact on teacher learning, classroom practice, and student outcomes. O'Meara et al. (2020) further noted that conventional PD often lacks personalization, sustained reflection, and inclusion, especially for adjunct and part-time faculty. Faculty frequently describe conventional PD as one-size-fits-all, compliance oriented, and disconnected from daily realities. AI-driven PD represents a potential paradigm shift. Using adaptive systems, recommender engines, intelligent tutoring, and AI-enabled mentoring platforms, institutions can offer personalized, on-demand learning that evolves with faculty needs (Ajani et al., 2024; Fakhar et al., 2024). Unlike isolated one-off sessions, AI-driven PD supports continuous, embedded learning integrated into everyday practice.

Grounded in andragogy and extended by Knowles et al. (2015), AI-driven PD aligns with adult learners' needs for autonomy, relevance, and self-direction (Knowles, 1980). Heutagogy, according to Hase and Kenyon (2000), goes further, positioning faculty as co-creators of their learning, adapting, curating, and shaping AI-enabled

environments. A key distinction lies in evaluation: Traditional PD is often judged by attendance or satisfaction, whereas AI-driven PD can offer longitudinal, data-rich insights into engagement, reflection, and pedagogical growth (Bond et al., 2024). These affordances introduce ethical complexities of privacy, surveillance, bias, and consent that must be addressed transparently (McGrath et al., 2023). This contrast underscores the need for research that moves beyond technological efficiency to explore faculty perceptions, agency, and ethical alignment. When grounded in andragogical and heutagogical principles, AI-driven PD can support transformative learning by empowering faculty as autonomous, reflective, and ethically engaged professionals.

Benefits of AI for Faculty Development

AI-driven PD offers personalization, real-time feedback, and automation. Fakhar et al. (2024) showed that AI supports individualized learning paths based on modality, discipline, and professional goals. Algorithms recommend adaptive content and modules aligned with performance or stated interests (Ajani et al., 2024). Real-time feedback fosters reflective practice and evidence-based teaching (Al-Mughairi & Bhaskar, 2024). Automation of routine tasks, grading, and analytics frees time for innovative pedagogy and deeper student engagement (Ajani et al., 2024). Together, these affordances position AI as both a catalyst for efficiency and a tool for reflection and creative growth in faculty learning.

Challenges to Adoption and Implementation

Despite these benefits, adoption faces barriers. Faculty resistance may arise from fears of job displacement, perceived complexity, or erosion of autonomy (Munir & Hanif, 2024). Limited training and inconsistent institutional support further discourage

engagement (McGrath et al., 2023). Usefulness and ease of use alone do not explain adoption. As Nelson (2024) noted, academic identity and institutional culture significantly shape whether faculty engage with or resist technological change. For some, AI threatens professional autonomy; for others, it aligns with a culture of innovation. Concerns about return on investment complicate decision-making: AI-driven PD often yields incremental, context-dependent outcomes (Lo Conte, 2025). Ethical issues, privacy, and opacity also reduce trust (McGrath et al., 2023; Munir & Hanif, 2024). Importantly, much of the literature has privileged institutional perspectives over faculty voices, leaving lived experiences underexplored—an explicit gap this study addressed.

Innovative Models and Practical Applications

Emerging models of PD frame learning as both an individual and an organizational endeavor. O'Meara et al. (2020) argued PD should reside within institutional learning systems that foster collective change, not merely individual growth. From this perspective, AI-driven PD should be designed for organizational transformation, supporting cultures of collaboration, equity, and ethical practice. AI tools enable outcome-based evaluation by analyzing longitudinal teaching data rather than relying solely on surveys (Ajani et al., 2024). They can capture emotional and behavioral dimensions of development engagement, reflection, and motivation that influence sustained growth. Synthesizing across the literature, AI-driven PD is most effective when:

1. Leadership provides protected time for engagement.
2. Faculty co-design content and processes.
3. Institutions ensure transparent data practices and opt-in participation.

4. Tiered supports meet varying digital literacy levels.
5. Equity measures (stipends, asynchronous cohorts, and devices) address access gaps.
6. Evaluation prioritizes teaching practice and reflective growth over attendance counts.

Theoretical Foundations

Figure 1 presents the conceptual framework that guided this study. At its core, the framework emphasizes that multiple, interrelated constructs shape faculty perceptions of AI-driven PD. TAM contributes perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use, while UTAUT2 adds performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, and facilitating conditions (Davis et al., 2024; Venkatesh, 2022). Emerging literature underscores affective and ethical considerations such as trust, fairness, fear, and excitement in shaping technology acceptance (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). Transformative learning theory positions PD not merely as skill acquisition but as critical reflection, meaning-making, and a paradigm shift in teaching practices (Mezirow, 1991). By integrating these perspectives, the framework provides a comprehensive lens to examine faculty experiences and perceptions. It situates AI-driven PD beyond efficiency and adoption, foregrounding ethical responsibility, human-centered values, and transformative change in higher education. This integrated model frames the research questions and informs both the design of the interview protocol and the initial coding categories used in analysis.

TAM

TAM explains technology adoption through perceived usefulness and ease of use (Davis et al., 2024). Studies have shown faculty adoption hinges on whether tools are intuitive and demonstrably improve teaching (Weibe, 2024).

UTAUT and UTAUT2

UTAUT expands TAM by incorporating performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, and facilitating conditions (Venkatesh, 2022). In higher education, adoption depends not only on usability but also on peer norms, institutional support, and culture (Acosta-Enriquez et al., 2024).

Affective Acceptance and Ethical Awareness

Recent studies have highlighted the importance of trust, fear, and ethical concerns in shaping adoption (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). Faculty who perceive AI as threatening autonomy may resist, while those who see it as supportive may engage enthusiastically.

Integrated Theoretical Model

Combining TAM, UTAUT2, and constructs of affective acceptance and ethical awareness provides a holistic framework: Adoption is influenced by utility, usability, social conditions, emotions, and ethical trust.

Reflexivity and Theoretical Positioning

As a practitioner-researcher, I interpreted these frameworks with attention to faculty agency, values, and ethics, ensuring the analysis remains human centered and context sensitive.

Gaps in the Literature

Existing studies often have privileged quantitative metrics over qualitative insights. Faculty voices, ethical concerns, and emotional experiences remain underexplored (Bond et al., 2024). Traditional frameworks such as TAM and UTAUT2 rarely incorporate affective or ethical dimensions (de Blanes Sebastián et al., 2022). Slepankova (2023) noted conceptual ambiguity in distinguishing AI-driven PD from general edtech or instructional technologies; without precision, findings are difficult to compare or replicate. Evaluation practices present another gap. Many studies rely on participation rates, satisfaction surveys, or completion certificates rather than evidence of changes in teaching practice, growth in AI literacy, or student outcomes. This narrows the view of effectiveness and obscures transformative learning. The present study responded by focusing on faculty self-reported shifts in practice, confidence, ethical reasoning, and perceived student impact captured through 18 open-ended interview questions (Appendix A) completed via Google Forms or an optional one-on-one interview.

Ethical and Human-Centered Considerations

Privacy, Bias, and Transparency

Selwyn (2019) cautioned that AI enthusiasm can overlook fundamental questions of power, autonomy, and human relationships at the heart of teaching. Trust must be earned through transparency, participatory design, and alignment with human-centered values. AI-driven PD raises concerns about data privacy, algorithmic bias, and opaque decision-making; faculty often lack clarity about how their data are collected or used (Ajani et al., 2024; Bond et al., 2024). Global guidance emphasizes that AI in education must prioritize human-centered, ethical, and transparent practices (UNESCO, 2023). The

OECD (2023) has framed AI adoption as both a pedagogical and a workforce-readiness imperative, calling for institutions to integrate AI literacy and PD into broader strategies for future skills.

Faculty Responsibility and Trust

Faculty increasingly see themselves as ethical agents in AI adoption but often lack adequate institutional guidance. Shared governance and transparent frameworks are essential to building trust (McGrath et al., 2023; Omrani et al., 2022).

Inclusion and Digital Access

AI risks deepening inequities if under-resourced faculty are excluded. Digital divides, funding gaps, and limited training exacerbate disparities (Ajani et al., 2024; Al Samman, 2024). Equitable design requires inclusive practices, culturally responsive content, and intentional supports (Omrani et al., 2022). Ethical adoption also relies on governance structures that safeguard rights and values; Stahl et al. (2022) proposed regional and international agencies to ensure alignment with human values. Critics warn of techno-solutionism, workload creep, threats to academic freedom, and surveillance; if framed as compliance rather than empowerment, AI-driven PD could undermine faculty agency. Balanced, participatory approaches are necessary to avoid these pitfalls.

Multidisciplinary Collaboration and Global Perspectives

Cross-Disciplinary Integration Needed

AI in education cannot be developed or deployed solely by technologists. Its design and adoption must integrate educators, ethicists, social scientists, and policymakers. Bond et al. (2024) argued that ethical rigor and interdisciplinary collaboration are critical for progress, while Bayaga (2025) highlighted the need for

pedagogical innovation grounded in context. Beyond technical concerns, Selwyn (2019) and Nelson (2024) asserted that faculty adoption is shaped by identity, trust, and institutional culture, making the humanities and social sciences essential partners. International bodies UNESCO (2023), OECD (2023), and the World Economic Forum (2023) have emphasized cross-sector collaboration to ensure AI advances equity, skills, and sustainability. Stahl et al. (2022) called for governance frameworks that safeguard fundamental rights. Together, these perspectives reinforce the need for co-designed, multidisciplinary, and globally informed AI-driven PD that balances innovation with human-centered values.

Global Adoption Differences

Global disparities reflect infrastructure, funding, and cultural factors. Developed systems often advance more quickly, while under-resourced institutions risk being left behind (Bayaga, 2025; Rahiman & Kodikal, 2024). For example, AI-enabled PD pilots in Finland and Singapore emphasize faculty co-design. In contrast, institutions in parts of Latin America and Africa face adoption barriers due to connectivity and funding constraints. The World Economic Forum (2023) has identified digital literacy, critical thinking, and adaptability as essential workforce skills; faculty PD that integrates AI plays a pivotal role in preparing students for these demands.

Collaborative Ethical Governance

Inclusive governance is essential for trust, accountability, and ethical oversight. Meta-analyses call for participatory governance structures that go beyond technical implementation (Al Samman, 2024; Bayaga, 2025). Faculty participation in AI governance strengthens alignment with academic values and institutional missions,

echoing O'Meara et al.'s (2020) view of PD as organizational learning. International organizations have stressed the importance of ethical governance at scale (OECD, 2023; UNESCO, 2023). Stahl et al. (2022) advocated for independent agencies to safeguard rights and values. Trust and transparency remain central: Addressing bias, privacy, and accountability requires collaboration across disciplines and stakeholders (Bond et al., 2024; Omrani et al., 2022). For institutions, this translates into faculty advisory councils, ethics boards, and co-design processes that actively involve educators in shaping AI-driven PD. Collaborative ethical governance is not an optional safeguard but a prerequisite for sustainable, human-centered adoption.

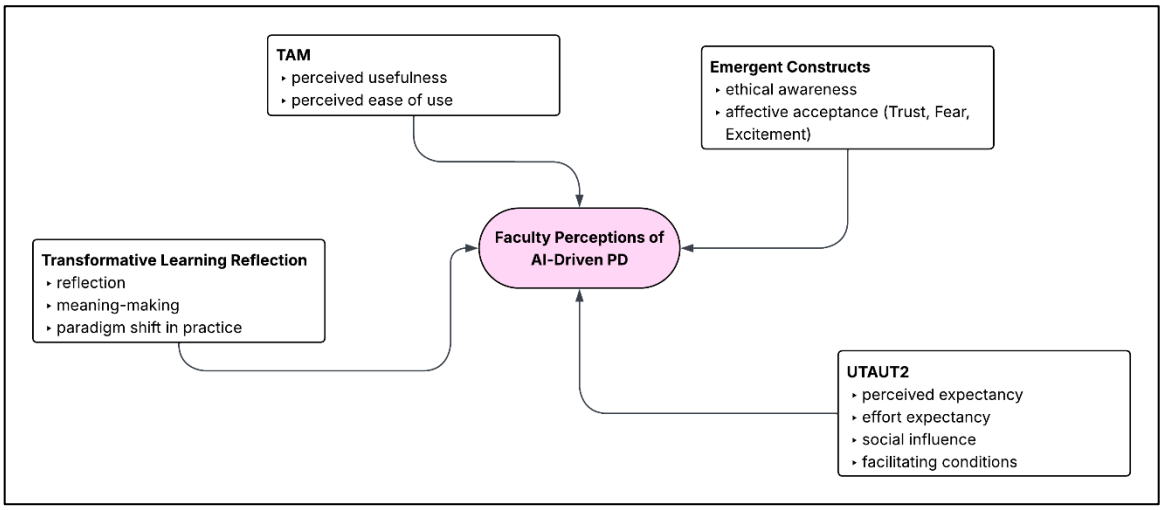
Bridging Literature Gaps

This study addressed several persistent gaps. First, prior research often has relied on quantitative metrics that provide limited insight into the complexity of faculty experiences. By foregrounding faculty voices and lived experience, this study emphasizes interpretive dimensions of professional learning that are frequently overlooked. Second, although TAM and UTAUT2 explain functional and behavioral factors, they rarely capture ethical and affective dimensions of trust, fear, and perceptions of fairness that strongly influence engagement. This study explicitly incorporated ethical awareness and affective acceptance into its framework. Third, the literature often has treated AI-driven PD as indistinguishable from general edtech or instructional technologies. Following Selwyn's (2019) critique of techno-optimism, this research clearly distinguished AI-driven PD as a specific domain linking efficiency claims to deeper concerns about equity, labor, identity, and agency. To respond, the present study employed a single-phase qualitative interview design using an 18-question faculty interview protocol (Appendix

A). It examined how faculty describe usefulness/effectiveness, human-centered values and ethics, readiness and agency, and future vision, thereby generating a richer and more nuanced understanding of AI in professional development, one that reflects both the promise and the complexity of integrating technology into higher-education systems.

Figure 1

Conceptual Framework for Faculty Perceptions of AI-Driven PD



Note. This framework integrates TAM, UTAUT2, emergent constructs of ethical awareness and affective acceptance, and transformative learning theory. Together, these models illustrate the multidimensional factors shaping faculty perceptions of AI-driven PD and guided both the interview design and the initial coding structure used in analysis.

Summary

The literature review demonstrated the steady and, most importantly, visible evolution of AI tools for higher education toward comprehensive practices of widespread use. Today, this is no longer limited to AI tutors and resources for predictive analytics of student performance and achievement, and tomorrow it may develop into even deeper and stronger integration. Modern solutions fully support curriculum objectives and

adaptive feedback requirements, enabling education to move into the realm of big, continuous data for analysis. However, it is also true that such growth can lead to increased points of conflict around issues of data confidentiality and privacy, as well as the limits of human judgment. The chapter showed that the teaching function must also change, as conservative, largely outdated forms of teaching are poorly suited to modern intellectual capabilities.

AI tools now act as a reflection mechanism, changing the role of teaching data to rethink entrenched attitudes. To embrace technology actively and willingly, the educational environment must continually find contextual balance within organizational conditions and social influence factors, as well as emotions and ethical transparency. This review results in an integrated framework that combines TAM, UTAUT2, affective constructs, and transformative learning theory. This framework perfectly justifies the research gap in how the lack of live teaching voices and practice-oriented outcome criteria shapes the structure of modern higher education. Given the problems identified and the valuable conclusions, the next logical step should be to choose a qualitative research design that, through open interviews, allows identification of the framework and dilemmas regarding the personalization of learning as a potential risk of hidden observation.

CHAPTER III

METHODOLOGY

Research Design

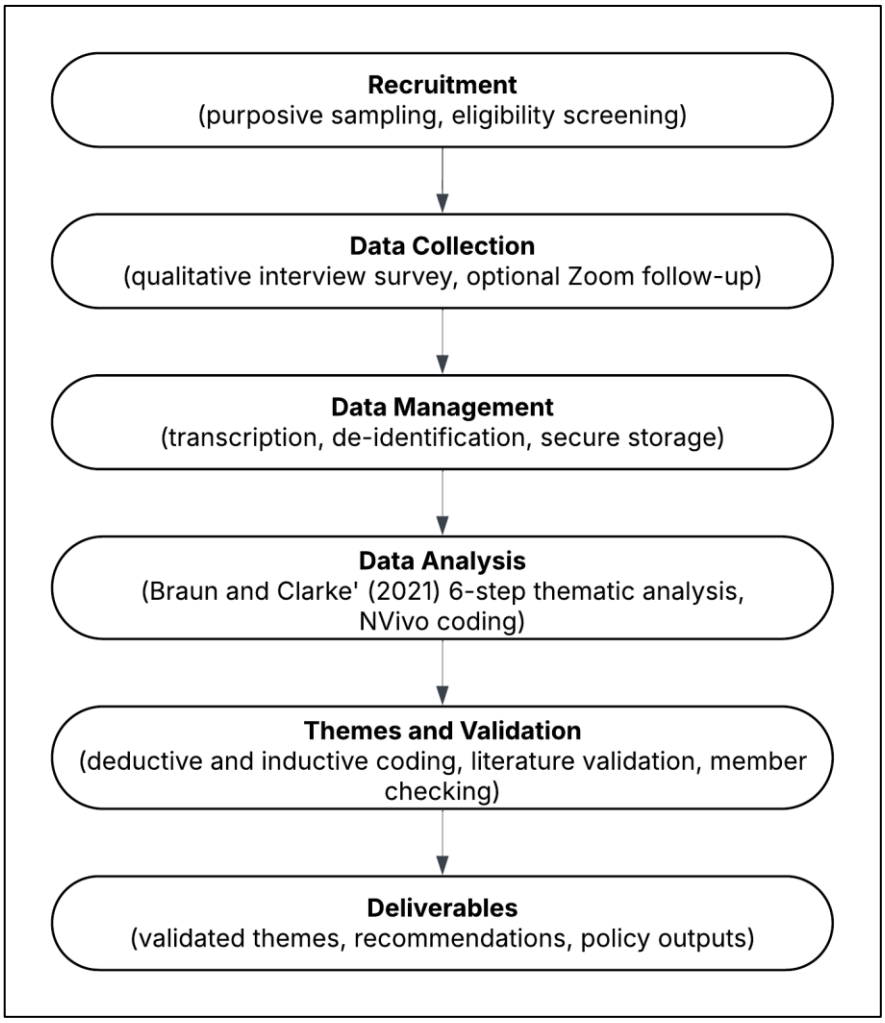
This study employed a qualitative research design within the interpretivist paradigm, which emphasizes understanding the meanings individuals construct from their lived experiences (Omodan, 2024). A qualitative approach was chosen because it provides the depth and flexibility needed to explore how higher education faculty perceive AI-driven PD. Unlike quantitative designs, qualitative inquiry privileges participant voice, context, and interpretation, elements critical to examining how AI-enabled PD is understood, valued, or resisted by faculty. The primary method was a qualitative interview survey, which combined structured demographic items with open-ended narrative prompts. This approach balanced breadth and depth: It documented participants' teaching context while eliciting detailed accounts of experiences, perceptions, and ethical reflections. The instrument consisted of 18 open-ended questions designed to function as an interview delivered in survey form, enabling faculty to respond in their own words and at their own pace. This design captured the reach of survey research with the richness of qualitative interviews.

The study's conceptual framework integrated the TAM, the UTAUT2, and emergent constructs such as ethical awareness, affective acceptance, and transformative learning. These frameworks guided both the design of the interview survey and the analytic lens applied to the data, ensuring alignment among theory, method, and findings.

As illustrated in Figure 2, the research process followed a sequential yet iterative cycle: purposive recruitment; interview-survey data collection with optional follow-ups; secure data management; thematic analysis using Braun and Clarke's (2021) six steps; validation through member checking, literature comparison, and triangulation; and, ultimately, the production of practice-oriented institutional deliverables (Figure 3).

Figure 2

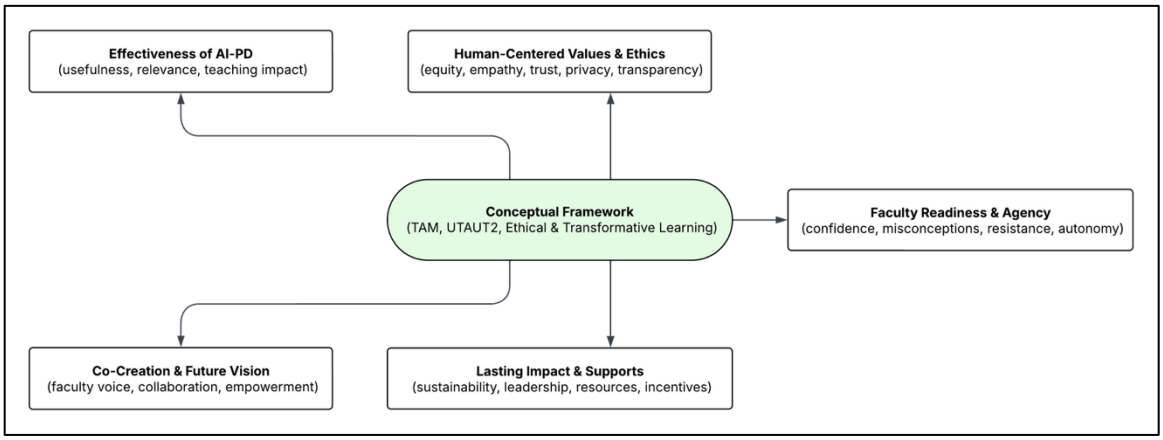
Research Process Flow Diagram



Note. This diagram shows the research process from recruitment to analysis and validation, culminating in practice-oriented deliverables.

Figure 3

Conceptual Framework for AI-Driven Professional Development



Note. This framework integrates TAM, UTAUT2, and constructs of ethical awareness, affective acceptance, and transformative learning. These models collectively inform five domains of inquiry that guided survey design, coding, and analysis.

Site of the Study and Rationale

The study was conducted virtually, allowing flexibility for faculty participation. Recruitment focused on faculty within the Los Angeles Community College District, which represents a diverse range of professional development environments, institutional resources, and teaching contexts. Conducting the study online through secure survey platforms and video conferencing was intentional; many AI-driven PD experiences are themselves digital, and virtual access reduced barriers for adjunct and part-time faculty who may have limited opportunities for institutionally sponsored PD. The structure of the survey and its alignment with the research questions are summarized in Table 1.

Table 1

Survey Sections, Research Questions, Themes, and Deliverables

Survey section	Research question(s)	Themes explored	Deliverables
A. Background & Context (Q1–Q6)	RQ1 (faculty perceptions shaped by role, discipline, and PD culture)	Faculty demographics, disciplinary context, institutional PD culture (compliance-driven, optional, innovative), and positioning of AI-PD	Descriptive participant profiles; mapping of institutional PD approaches and AI adoption readiness
B. Experiences & Effectiveness (Q7–Q11)	RQ1, RQ2 (usefulness, ease of use, effectiveness of AI-PD)	Faculty experiences with AI-PD vs. traditional PD; examples of compliance-driven vs. growth-oriented PD; teaching impact	Evidence of what makes AI-PD perceived as useful, relevant, or transformative; recommendations for designing effective PD
C. Human-Centered Values, Equity & Ethics (Q12–Q14)	RQ5, RQ7 (alignment with teaching values, ethical concerns)	Alignment with empathy, equity, creativity, and student-centeredness; accessibility across faculty groups; ethical concerns (privacy, bias, fairness, and transparency)	Ethical framework for AI-PD: principles for equity and trust-building in PD design
D. Readiness, Agency, & Misconceptions (Q15–Q16)	RQ2, RQ3, RQ6, and RQ8 (readiness, misconceptions, resistance, and agency)	Faculty confidence/readiness; misconceptions about AI; barriers to participation; compliance vs. agency/autonomy	Institutional checklist of supports (resources, communication, training); strategies for empowering faculty agency
E. Lasting Impact & Future Vision (Q17–Q18)	RQ4, RQ6, RQ8, and RQ9 (long-term impact, supports, co-creation, institutional policy influence)	Long-term sustainability; institutional supports; faculty-led co-creation; trust in institutional approaches	Roadmap for sustainable AI-PD; co-created strategies; faculty-informed policy and practice recommendations
Cross-Cutting Insights	All RQs	Trust, transparency, co-design, contextualization of AI-PD	Meta-findings for scholarship; actionable guidance for scalable, ethical, and human-centered PD

Data Collection

Data were collected through a secure online survey platform with optional follow-up interviews. Informed consent was obtained following best practices in clarity and participant autonomy. Bazzano et al. (2021) traced the modern history of informed consent, emphasizing the ethical obligation to provide key information and empower participants. This study adopted those principles: Participants were informed of the purpose, risks, benefits, and rights, and all participation remained voluntary. Each survey required approximately 45–60 minutes and included space for extended narrative responses. Participants provided informed consent prior to beginning. Responses were anonymized using unique ID codes. Where participants opted for a live interview, sessions were audio-recorded with consent, then transcribed and de-identified. Data collection continued until thematic saturation was reached.

Data Analysis

Responses were treated as interview transcripts, analyzed for thematic patterns, and coded using Braun and Clarke's (2021) six-step thematic analysis:

1. familiarization
2. initial coding
3. theme development
4. theme review
5. theme definition/naming
6. reporting

Codes clustered into themes such as trust and transparency, compliance versus agency, equity in access, misconceptions about AI, and co-creation of PD. Final themes

were mapped to the research questions and conceptual framework. To enhance validity, emergent themes were cross-validated with prior literature, highlighting both alignment and novel contributions (Ajani et al., 2024; McGrath et al., 2023). Analysis was supported with NVivo.

Research Quality Assurance

Using an interview survey design increased accessibility for faculty with limited time while preserving the qualitative depth of interviews. This approach enhanced both credibility and transferability by making participation feasible without sacrificing narrative richness. Rigor was established following Lincoln and Guba's (1985) criteria:

Credibility: Ensured through member checking with volunteer participants and triangulation across written survey narratives and optional follow-up interviews.

Transferability: Supported by providing thick descriptions of participant contexts, institutional cultures, and professional development settings to allow readers to assess applicability in other contexts.

Dependability: Maintained through an audit trail documenting coding decisions, analytic memos, and methodological choices.

Confirmability: Strengthened by reflexive journaling and peer debriefs, ensuring that interpretations reflected participants' voices rather than researcher bias.

Researcher Positionality and Reflexivity

As a scholar-practitioner in higher education and educational technology, I recognized the potential for interpretive bias in analyzing faculty responses. To mitigate this, I engaged in reflexive journaling, actively sought disconfirming evidence, minimized premature analytic decisions, and incorporated member checks with

volunteers. These strategies reinforced confirmability, enhanced credibility, and increased the trustworthiness of the study's findings.

Limitations

As a qualitative study, the findings are not intended for broad statistical generalization. Instead, they offer context-rich insights into how faculty perceive AI-driven professional development. Several limitations should be acknowledged. First, the study relied on self-reported data, which may be influenced by social desirability bias or participants' varying levels of familiarity with AI (Teessar, 2024). Second, the use of purposive sampling may have resulted in an over-representation of faculty who are either more open to or more critical of AI, potentially narrowing the range of perspectives. Third, the study's focus on faculty within the LACCD may not fully capture institutional or policy variations across broader higher education contexts. Finally, the researcher's professional background in higher education and educational technology may have shaped interpretations. This risk was mitigated through reflexive journaling, member checks, and peer debriefs, strengthening confirmability (Duffy et al., 2022). Despite these limitations, the study provides valuable and actionable insights into faculty perceptions of AI-driven PD. Its contributions lie in deepening the understanding of how faculty engage with emerging technologies in professional development, highlighting opportunities and challenges for institutions seeking to design equitable, ethical, and sustainable PD models.

Summary

The outputs of this study align directly with the five survey domains (A–E), ensuring that findings address the research questions and contribute both scholarly insights and institution-ready resources:

- Faculty Profiles & Context (A): Mapping of institutional PD cultures and readiness
- Effectiveness of AI-PD (B): Evidence of what makes AI-PD transformative versus superficial
- Human-Centered Values and Ethics (C): An ethical framework grounded in faculty values and concerns
- Readiness, Agency, and Misconceptions (D): An institutional checklist of supports that strengthen faculty confidence and agency
- Lasting Impact and Future Vision (E): A faculty-informed roadmap for sustainable, co-created PD

In addition to these domain-specific outputs, cross-cutting insights were expected, including trust and transparency as critical enablers, co-design and faculty voice as essential drivers of engagement, and the inadequacy of one-size-fits-all PD models. The final deliverables may include the following:

1. Peer-reviewed publications and conference presentations that extend theoretical frameworks
2. An institutional AI-PD toolkit with recommendations, design principles, and checklists
3. A faculty empowerment brief amplifying faculty voice and informing policy.

Together, these outputs respond to the study's significance outlined in Chapters I and II, bridging research and practice. The methodology presented in this chapter ensures that the design remains coherent, theory informed, and centered on faculty voice. By aligning the interview survey with the research questions, coding domains, and deliverables, and situating the process within clear conceptual and analytic frameworks, the study was positioned to yield findings that are both rigorous and actionable. Ultimately, this design advances scholarly understanding while equipping institutions with practical strategies for developing ethical, effective, and sustainable AI-driven professional development.

CHAPTER IV

FINDINGS

Purpose of the Study

This chapter provides the results of a qualitative analysis of 10 written interview responses that were provided by 10 members of the faculty of higher education located throughout the LACCD. This chapter has the aim of outlining the perception and experience of AI-based PD as perceived by faculty, with special focus on usefulness, effectiveness, human-centered values, ethical concerns, and professional agency. Braun and Clarke's (2021) six-phase thematic analysis was used to analyze the data. Written survey responses were considered as transcripts of interviews and coded through a finalized codebook (Appendix F). To establish credibility, dependability, and confirmability, codes were developed inductively through multiple close readings of the data, constant comparison across participant responses, and the use of analytic memos to document emerging interpretations and researcher reflections throughout the coding process. This iterative approach allowed themes to emerge from the data rather than being imposed by predetermined assumptions.

The data set reflected a wide range of faculty perspectives, including enthusiasm and optimism toward AI adoption, uncertainty and skepticism, and resistance and concern. Participants also provided rich narrative reflections that contributed depth and complexity to the analysis. The diversity of perspectives strengthened the trustworthiness of the findings by ensuring that multiple viewpoints were represented and examined.

Findings were organized thematically rather than by individual participant. Themes were identified through recurring patterns of meaning across faculty narratives and captured areas of convergence, divergence, and tension within participants' experiences. This approach allowed for a deeper understanding of how faculty perceived, experienced, and navigated the integration of artificial intelligence within their professional practice.

Research Questions

This study formulated a central question aimed at understanding how higher education teachers perceive and experience professional development based on AI tools. The research question was broken down into components to explore patterns that may emerge in the experiences of teachers, as well as gaps that could influence resistance to change. Among other things, the questions also included exploring the general perception of AI tools for teaching practice and their impact on working with students.

Participant Selection

Participant Profile

The population of interest was higher education faculty within LACCD who had participated in at least one AI-related PD activity, including the following:

1. General PD enhanced by AI tools, such as adaptive platforms or automated feedback
2. PD focused on teaching about AI: workshops on AI integration in classrooms
3. AI literacy programs, such as training on evaluating and using AI

A purposive sampling strategy was used to recruit participants who could provide rich, relevant insights (Braun & Clarke, 2021). The study sought approximately 10

participants, monitoring saturation operationally as two consecutive interviews yielded no new codes/themes.

Inclusion criteria: Current faculty appointment (adjunct, part-time, or full-time), participation in at least one AI-related PD activity, and willingness to complete the interview survey.

Exclusion criteria: No exposure to AI-related PD. Recruitment was conducted via academic mailing lists and professional networks. Interested participants completed an eligibility form before receiving the survey link.

Interview Structure

The final interview survey consisted of 18 open-ended questions organized into five thematic domains. This was not a fixed-choice survey but rather an interview conducted in written form, designed to give participants flexibility in both the time taken and the depth of their responses. The prompts were narrative oriented, encouraging faculty to reflect on their experiences, values, and perceptions in their own words.
The five domains were structured as follows:

- Section A: Background & Context demographic and institutional context
- Section B: Experiences & Effectiveness perceptions of AI-PD in relation to TAM/UTAUT2 constructs such as usefulness, ease of use, and comparative effectiveness
- Section C: Human-Centered Values, Equity, and Ethics alignment with faculty values, accessibility across groups, and considerations of privacy, bias, and transparency

- Section D: Readiness, Agency, and Misconceptions faculty confidence, common misconceptions, and the tension between compliance-driven and agency-driven PD
- Section E: Lasting Impact & Future Vision sustainability, institutional supports, co-creation, and trust in institutional approaches

Findings

RQ1: Faculty Experiences of AI-Driven Professional Development

RQ1 investigated the experience of AI-based professional development by faculty and its relationship with transformative learning theory. A large number of respondents indicated that AI-PD was transformative, as it led to reflection and experimentation in their teaching. Others perceived it as being more transactional, with no depth or dialogue in the modules required. Indications of viewpoint changes, critical thinking, and self-guided implementation refer directly to transformative learning theory, indicating that significant AI-PD happens when faculty associate the tools with pedagogy and self-concept.

Professional Development Driven by AI Is on a Spectrum Between Compliance and Transformation

Faculty continuously explained AI-based professional development as present on a continuum between compliance-based participation and transformative professional development. This difference disproportionately influenced the ways that faculty assessed the relevance, value, and impact of AI-PD across disciplines and types of appointments. Instead of characterizing AI-PD as being generally either effective or ineffective, respondents defined their experiences as conditional based on design, intent, and

circumstance. The participants noted that the institutional offering might be viewed as different when it promoted autonomy, experimentation, and dialogue. The spectrum framework was developed inductively as a result of recurrent contrasts between those sessions that were described as mandatory or policy driven, and those that were described as exploratory, collaborative, or reflective. The faculty stories indicated that transformative potential did not belong to the structure of AI tools but was a result of professional learning organizations.

Compliance-Driven AI-PD as Institutional Obligation

According to many of the participants, professional development, especially AI-related PD, is largely compliance based. These experiences were marked with compulsory attendance, acknowledgement of policies, or compulsory completion as opposed to genuine involvement. Words such as “required,” “checkbox,” or “something to get through” were often used by the faculty, denoting that the whole activity was seen as a mechanism of institutional responsibility and not professional development. It was common, in these descriptions, to introduce AI-PD as a reaction to the perceived problem of plagiarism, academic integrity, cybersecurity, or institutional risk, and not as an innovative teaching opportunity. Interviewees noted that sessions paid a lot of attention to explanations of the policies, risk mitigation measures, and lists of the prohibited uses. Although they admitted that institutional guidelines were essential, they observed that these sessions were seldom directly related to the teaching practice.

Faculty reported minimal chances of discussion or contextualizing. A number of interviewees also noted that time limits did not allow them to have a comprehensive discussion and learn it on a deeper level. Others reported materials to be generic, not

considering the differences in disciplines. Adjunct faculty and noncredit interlocutors also mentioned secondary frustration at not being compensated during compulsory sessions, which confirms the idea of AI-PD as an administrative obligation instead of an investment in a profession.

Even though compliance-based PD was not defined as harmful, it was always perceived as low impact. Faculty stressed that engaging in such conditions did not make much difference to their teaching performance and their belief in working with AI. Rather, the interaction was formal. Participants took the necessary modules but seldom incorporated knowledge into their teaching structure. This trend follows the description of the transactional type of learning, when information is passed across without critical examination. Notably, compliance requirements were not explicitly opposed by faculty. Instead, they defined the difference between certain policy orientations and rational pedagogical growth. It was also proposed on numerous occasions that compliance-focused sessions might be a baseline entry point, although it should not be the whole of the institutional AI-PD action.

Transformative AI-PD as Reflective and Practice-Based Learning

Faculty, on the contrary, referred to AI-PD as being transformative when it is perceived to be reflective and hands-on and when it is directly related to the teaching practice. Such experiences were frequently voluntary or semi-structured experiences where the focus was on experimentation, dialogue, and application and not on completion. The respondents were asked to describe workshops in which instructors invited AI tools to be tested, had to redesign assignments, or discussed scenarios in groups about ethics. Such sessions were termed invigorating and thought-provoking. The

faculty emphasized the possibility to experiment with prompt design, be biased in outputs, and critique the output of AI generated in conversation with peers. The characteristic feature became reflection. Teachers indicated that they started to rethink their old-time assumptions regarding assessment, authorship, and student learning.

Peer interaction, coaching, or long-term learning communities were often associated with transformative experiences as opposed to single workshops. In semester-long cohorts or other discipline-based groups that faculty have participated in, iterative cycles of implementation and feedback were described. The process of learning occurred gradually, in which instructors got the chance to experiment, analyze the results, and modify learning practices to the needs of the students. These were long interactions that created a feeling of trust and less concern over AI adoption.

The respondents linked transformative AI-PD to perspective changes in line with the transformative learning theory. Some of these articulated experiences of disorienting dilemma, where early anxieties regarding the effects of AI on academic integrity eventually gave way to an acknowledgement of the potential effects of AI on pedagogy. Others noted that they explored themselves more with each other after collaborative sessions. Faculty presented AI as an inclusive feedback and brainstorming tool and as a threat at the same time. Nevertheless, transformative organizational experiences were not universal. Some of the respondents stated that the solution would be meaningful engagement, but only after having background knowledge. Without support from the introductory ones, the experimentation was overpowering. This implies that transformative AI-PD relies on sequencing and differentiated design as opposed to individual invention.

RQ2: Misconceptions and Knowledge Gaps

RQ2 investigated the wrong beliefs and knowledge gaps presented by faculty and the impact they had on getting involved with AI-PD. In multiple interviews, respondents explained that there are a number of common misconceptions regarding AI capabilities, limitations, and applications. These stereotypes predicted preparedness to engage in professional learning and formed a perspective on what an institution was offering. Many of the most popular myths were the belief that AI was going to eclipse teachers, that AI results were accurate, or that AI was initially applicable to STEM fields. Part of the faculty associated AI only with generating text tools without considering its use in access, analytics, or design. Still others equated automation with augmentation and believed that AI is an autonomous system that acts independently, not as a collaborative system that needs human supervision. Another gap in knowledge was seen in ethical use, data privacy, and institutional support structures. The faculty often doubted licensed tools and licensing dealings, as well as privacy considerations. Some of the respondents mentioned that they did not know whom to consult or where to find help in technical aspects. The misconceptions minimized the readiness to participate in PD and further supported the necessity of introductory, literacy-oriented courses. Respondents who rated AI as threatening in nature tended to be defensive about PD. On the other hand, the individuals who had the baseline knowledge were more curious and open.

Faculty Motivation Toward AI-PD Is Conditional and Not Attitudinal

In all cases, the involvement of faculty in AI-PD was influenced not personally, like attitudes toward AI, but by structural and institutional factors. Faculty who were open, curious, or skeptical all detailed barriers and supports that affected their degree of

engagement. This observation makes the assumption that resistance is more attitudinally difficult.

Time, Workload, and Scheduling as Structural Barriers

Time limitations and the workload were consistently cited by the participants as the main obstacles to using AI-PD. Faculty reported conflicting commitments, little time compensated by professional learning, and time conflicts, especially with adjunct and noncredit instructors. These obstacles were presented in a pragmatic and not ideological way. Absence of involvement was reported as a result of structural reality and not the unwillingness to be innovative. A number of the instructors indicated that they were willing to participate as long as PD was incorporated into the current departmental meetings or accompanied by stipends. In the absence of guarded time, AI-PD was perceived as added baggage to the already existing duties. The issues of workload were acute, particularly with faculty members who taught more than one section or subject with service responsibilities. The interviewees reported that to learn AI tools, they had to test them outside of the workshops. The institution did not accept this kind of labor, so long-term involvement was challenging.

Clarity and Communication Shape Readiness

Confusion about the purpose, scope, and intended audience of AI-related PD was also reported by faculty. The offerings were commonly viewed to be either poorly packaged, poorly communicated, or not differentiated enough in terms of skill or discipline. This ambiguity caused reluctance and disproportional involvement. Faculty were not sure what, specifically, AI-PD opportunities applied to their teaching conditions or if they could be used at their level of experience. Others missed sessions they believed

were too advanced or went to workshops that were too introductory. Institutional communication practices, however, not only influenced the willingness to engage but also determined it. Respondents stressed the need to have clear glosses, stepped pyramids, and framing discipline. Effective communication of objectives, degree of expected results, and ethical standards made it more comfortable and trustworthy.

RQ3: Attitudes, Participation, and Resistance

RQ3 revealed that faculty participation could not be reduced to simple categories of acceptance or resistance. Instead, participation reflected a dynamic negotiation among curiosity, caution, professional identity, and institutional expectations. Faculty described weighing the potential benefits of AI against concerns related to pedagogy, ethics, workload, and academic integrity. Their willingness to engage in professional development was influenced not only by compliance requirements but also by how AI aligned with their values, teaching philosophies, and perceptions of their role as educators.

Faculty Approach to AI in Different Contexts: Instructional Innovation and Academic Integrity

The accounts of the faculty indicated two overwhelming orientations toward AI that defined the attitude to AI-PD and practice of AI, that is, instructional innovation and academic integrity. Those orientations were based on professional accountability and disciplinary background and not on the degree of openness or incompetence.

Instructional Innovation Orientation

Faculty who identified themselves as having an instructional innovation orientation explained the use of AI to improve teaching and learning. The concept of AI

presented itself as a lesson-planning tool, feedback source, accessibility tool, and organizing and instructional design tool. To these participants, AI-PD was in demand as it presented applied strategies, classroom applications, and the provision of experimentation. Such faculty members frequently recorded interest-based engagement. They used workshops voluntarily, studied tools by themselves, and exchanged results with coworkers. Reflective adaptation was defined by growth-oriented engagement as opposed to uncritical adoption. Respondents underlined the importance of having pedagogical judgment and using AI to enhance efficiency or inclusivity.

Academic Integrity Orientation

Other faculty members mainly interacted with AI on issues related to cheating, plagiarism, misinformation, and assessment control. AI was positioned as an issue that needed surveillance, identification, or redesigns of tasks to maintain quality and respectability. In this orientation, risk management frequently passes through AI-PD instead of an instructional opportunity. Faculty pointed out the importance of effective policies, moral advice, and institutional backing to maneuver through issues of integrity. There was occasional resistance in the face of PD reducing these risks or the promotion of rapid adoption by not taking precautions. These orientations were described analytically as functional perspectives as opposed to hierarchical positions. Most faculty exhibited aspects of both, indicating that preparation of transformative learning relies not on prioritizing integrity issues over instructional innovation or vice versa.

RQ4: Teaching Practices and Student Outcomes

RQ4 explored how faculty members viewed AI-augmented professional development as impacting their student learning and outcomes. In interviews and open-

ended answers, participants talked about effects that included significant pedagogical changes and few or even adverse effects. Although not every faculty member reported change, there was evidence of significant but moderate changes in assignment design, formative assessment, and student engagement experienced when AI-PD became practice based and reflective. Faculty who were positively impacted redesigned the assessment to encourage higher-order cognition with iterative, reflective assignments and with the help of AI as a brainstorming partner, though the results had to be critically evaluated. The majority of the enhanced formative feedback consisted of modifying AI-generated comments and rubrics, which enhanced their timeliness and interactivity. A neutral effect came when there was no follow-up or relevance of professional development. The added workload, lack of clear policies, and distrust of inaccuracies are negative experiences. Altogether, AI-PD contributed to the progressive transformation under intelligent consideration.

Human-Centered Values Are a Limit to AI Acceptance

A human-focused value turned out to be a definitive frontier that determined whether AI-PD would become classroom adoption. Faculty decisions were always made in terms of an oath to empathy, equity, relational engagement, and discipline. The acceptance of AI was preconditioned on adherence to these professional values.

Student Support and Alignment Through Accessibility

Faculty explained AI in a positive way when it improved accessibility and assisted other students. Some of these examples were the production of alternative explanations of complicated concepts, the scaffolding of multilingual learning, and the development of accessible study guides. Those interviewed who teach writing-intensive

or multilingual courses indicated that AI-aided writing could give learners a chance to eliminate their first writing barriers without necessarily compromising critical rewrites. AI was also termed helpful in arranging course materials, creating practice questions, and modeling the approaches toward analytics. When presented as an augmentation but not as a replacement, the concept of AI corroborated faculty values of inclusive pedagogy. The teachers insisted that they retained the ultimate decision, which they could edit to add a discipline twist and subjectivity. In these circumstances, AI was considered to increase the teaching space without reducing relational presence.

Misalignment by Dehumanization or Standardization

On the other hand, the faculty said they felt uneasy when AI-PD was seen to encourage automation that is not connected to human evaluation. Issues revolved around depersonalization, loss of pedagogical proficiency, and over-standardization. Participants were averse to the idea of delegating central teaching roles, especially those related to mentoring, assessment, or interpersonal care. Other faculty feared that the use of AI-made content might remove authenticity or even homogenize course content. There was also discomfort among others regarding surveillance-oriented usage in detection and surveillance. These issues were put into the context not as technical arguments but rather as moral lines of defense of the relational essence of teaching. Notably, the faculty was not categorically against AI. Instead, they expressed conditional acceptance in relation to the preservation of empathy, equity, and professional agency in the case of AI use. Human-centered commitments, therefore, acted as interpretive lenses that dictated the effects of AI-PD on practice.

RQ5: Congruency With the Human-Centered Values

RQ5 examined the faculty perceptions of AI-led PD as supportive of or antagonistic to human-based teaching values. The results showed the presence of a subtle ethical-affective environment where the involvement was based on the perceived compatibility of technological innovation with moral obligations. Faculty saw a high correspondence between creativity, accessibility, and empathy being modeled by AI-based professional development. The inclusive design, mitigating bias, and student diversity workshops were viewed positively as facilitators demonstrated uncertainty and promoted discussion of ethical dilemmas. Conversely, misalignment was present when AI-PD was based on non-discussion, non-contextual, impersonal automated modules. Faculty stressed that learning must be a matter of give and take and critical questioning and not purely technical teaching. Issues of equity were also important. The participants raised the question of whether AI tools are biased in favor of some language or cultural standards and cited the differences in access to technology among students. These inequities were not addressed, and this led to more hesitation. On the whole, AI-PD enhanced involvement in scenarios that supported relational teaching values and undermined them in one that approached education in an instrumental manner.

Ethical Concerns Are Trust Conditions and Not Absolute Principles

Ethical issues arose through narratives as efficient conditions of trust. Faculty did not raise the issues using abstract theoretical terms but rather in fact-based terms of privacy, bias, transparency, and institutional purpose.

Privacy, Bias, and Transparency as Preconditions of Engagement

The respondents stressed the need to comprehend the way AI tools gather and process data. The lack of clarity regarding data storage, third-party access, or the source of algorithmic training minimized the desire to experiment. Faculty demanded clarity in instructions on the permissible use, data protection, and measures of bias mitigation. Prejudice was often cited as an aspect of content production. Humanities and social science faculty members were worried about the fact that an AI could create a dominant narrative or stereotype. An openness about restrictions and the factual awareness of biases was defined as a key factor of responsible classroom integration. When AI-PD discussed these problems directly, comfort and experimentation rose.

Institutional Intent Influences Ethical Comfort

Faculty associated ethical comfort with institutional motivation. Trust was lost when AI initiatives were viewed as a cost-cutting or labor-replacement action. Respondents expressed the threat that automation would be used to cut jobs in place of instructors or impose too much standardization on the curriculum. Conversely, ethical issues were alleviated when institutions shared freely and faculty participated in policy-making. The processes of shared governance became an indicator of decision-making based on faculty expertise and enhanced confidence. Alignment of ethics was therefore relational as well as situational, rather than technical.

RQ6: Faculty Confidence and Support Needed

RQ6 examined what faculty reported about their confidence in critically evaluating AI tools and what they reported as needed to perform meaningfully and ethically using those tools. The level of confidence was diverse, with some self-reporting

as early adopters and others reporting as being unprepared or hesitant. Faculty with greater confidence tended to have previous exposure to or use of digital technology, belong to collaborative communities, or have had to experiment independently. They appreciated learning by doing and reflection and regarded uncertainty as something that they could handle with the support of the institution. Others were more concerned about experimentation, which they could do, but were not sure of the limits of ethics and wanted a structured teaching plan and discussion with professionals. The third group did not feel ready, and advanced use required a baseline of literacy. Faculty at all levels stressed organized training, mentoring, examples specific to a given field, technical assistance, and ethical counseling, pointing out that one-off sessions could never be effective and long-term involvement was a key factor in successful AI incorporation.

Faculty Define Effective AI-PD as Co-Designed, Supported, and Iterative

Faculty expressed an internally aligned vision of successful AI-based PD based on agency, organizational underpinning, and long-term cooperation.

Agency and Choice Facilitate Engagement

Independence became imminent. Faculty expressed more motivation when the participation was optional or personalized. Choice enabled instructors to match AI discovery with the needs and professional identity of the discipline. Mandated sessions, on the other hand, lowered intrinsic interest and strengthened compliance discourses.

Structural Supports Signal Institutional Commitment

Participants made very specific focuses on concrete supports in the form of stipends, access to licensed tools, sandbox environments, and orderly learning opportunities. Payments were seen as an appreciation of faculty work. Availability of

institutionally vetted and secure tools decreased privacy and quality anxiety. Another point of emphasis for the faculty was the need to have a time of protection to experiment. Unless there were adjustments to the workload, even interested instructors found it hard to participate meaningfully. The role of structural support was therefore twofold: as a convenient assistance and, at the same time, as an affirmation of institutional commitment.

Faculty Voice in Institutional AI Decision-Making Empowers Trust

In addition to individual participation, faculty indicated that they would like to be involved in institutional planning of AI. Trust and relevance were facilitated through inclusion in committees, policy drafting, and the design of PD. There was an increased skepticism and a higher likelihood of AI-PD being experienced as compliance-driven when the decision-making process was viewed as top-down. The shared governance forms were linked to elevated moral comfort and eagerness to innovate. The faculty perceived participatory processes as a way to reconcile AI adoption with academic values and not administrative expediency.

RQ7: Ethical Concerns and Recommendations

RQ7 concentrated specifically on ethical issues and recommendations of the faculty. Ethical concerns were rampant within disciplines and types of appointment. According to the respondents, bias, data privacy, transparency of the algorithm, and surveillance were the main points of concern. There were concerns among faculty that the AI tools, such as the grading system and predictive analytics, would promote inequity unless reviewed, focusing on their bias, privacy, and ownership of data. The existence of fear of surveillance was evident, especially in the case of plagiarism detection, where

overvaluing the surveillance may have the potential to form hostile classroom environments and build a lack of trust. The absence of transparency regarding data policies decreased trust and underlined the necessity of clear institutional policies and engagement of the faculty in establishing data policies. To avert these fears, participants suggested equity-principled assessment; analysis of devices for prejudice, availability, and disparate influence prior to adoption; and continuous evaluation because of the swift technological future. Balanced communications that would consider the potential of AI and its weaknesses were encouraged. Altogether, the ethical considerations were positioned as a prerequisite to responsible interaction, and the trust, transparency, and human-centered values were defined as essential in preconditioning the readiness of faculty to embrace AI-driven professional growth.

RQ8: Faculty Perceptions of Professional Agency, Autonomy, and Transformative Capacity in AI-Driven Professional Development

RQ8 explored how faculty perceive AI-driven professional development as shaping their professional agency, autonomy, and capacity for transformative practice. Responses revealed that AI-PD does not inherently enhance or diminish agency; rather, its impact is mediated by design, institutional framing, and the degree of faculty control embedded within the learning experience. Faculty consistently described AI-PD as existing on a spectrum between professional augmentation and institutional regulation. Their perceptions of autonomy and transformative capacity were shaped less by the technology itself and more by how it was governed.

AI-Driven Professional Development as Either Empowerment or Encroachment

Faculty frequently characterized AI-PD as having dual potential. When positioned as a flexible tool that expands instructional creativity, AI-PD was perceived as enhancing professional agency. Participants described feeling more capable of designing assignments, generating examples, differentiating instruction, and revising feedback processes. In these cases, AI functioned as an extension of professional expertise rather than a substitute for it. Respondents emphasized that their authority over instructional decisions remained intact, and this preservation of discretion reinforced their sense of autonomy.

Conversely, when AI-PD was perceived as prescriptive or compliance oriented, faculty reported concerns about diminished autonomy. Some respondents described apprehension regarding algorithmic standardization, administrative monitoring, or institutional pressure to adopt AI practices uniformly. In these narratives, AI-PD was interpreted as potentially encroaching upon pedagogical judgment. Rather than feeling empowered, faculty expressed caution about institutional motives and the possibility of reduced instructional independence. This polarity between empowerment and encroachment emerged inductively across survey responses. Faculty did not reject AI outright; instead, they drew a clear boundary between supportive augmentation and administrative overreach. The distinction centered on whether AI served faculty agency or structured it.

Professional Agency as Conditional and Context Dependent

Participants described professional agency as conditional upon meaningful choice. Voluntary participation, space for experimentation, and opportunities for dialogue

were repeatedly associated with increased feelings of professional ownership. Faculty reported that when AI-PD invited exploration rather than compliance, they were more willing to integrate tools into their practice. Respondents emphasized that agency is experienced when instructors retain authority to decide when, how, and whether AI tools are used. Several faculty indicated that autonomy was preserved when AI was framed as "optional," "adaptive," or "discipline-specific." In contrast, mandatory standardization or policy-heavy implementation reduced the perception of professional discretion. Importantly, faculty did not equate guidance with control. Institutional clarity regarding ethical boundaries, academic integrity, and data privacy was largely accepted as necessary. However, respondents differentiated between guardrails and directives. Agency was maintained when policies provided structure without prescribing pedagogy.

Transformative Capacity Rooted in Reflective Authority

Faculty associated transformative practice not with the presence of AI tools but with their ability to critically interpret and apply them. Respondents described transformative moments occurring when AI prompted reconsideration of assessment design, feedback strategies, and authorship norms. In these instances, AI catalyzed reflective inquiry rather than a technical shortcut. Transformative capacity was strengthened when AI-PD included collaborative dialogue, ethical discussion, and iterative experimentation. Faculty indicated that peer-based exploration reduced fear and increased confidence. Several responses reflected elements aligned with transformative learning theory, including perspective shifts regarding academic integrity, student authorship, and digital literacy. However, participants consistently noted that transformative outcomes required sustained engagement. One-time workshops or

technical demonstrations were perceived as insufficient to produce lasting shifts in practice. Faculty emphasized that transformation emerges through reflection, application, and adaptation over time.

Concerns Regarding Surveillance and Professional Identity

A notable undercurrent across responses involved concern about surveillance and professional identity. Some faculty expressed unease that AI-driven systems could be used to monitor teaching practices or evaluate productivity. Although these concerns were not dominant across all responses, they signaled sensitivity to institutional power dynamics. Faculty viewed pedagogical judgment as central to their professional identity. AI-PD was perceived as threatening when it appeared to automate or override that judgment. Respondents distinguished between tools that support expertise and systems that potentially displace it. This distinction highlights the importance of trust in institutional AI implementation.

Synthesis of Findings

Overall, faculty perceptions indicated that AI-driven professional development shapes professional agency through governance, framing, and design rather than through technology alone. Agency increases when AI-PD reinforces faculty discretion, supports reflective inquiry, and invites collaborative experimentation. Agency decreases when AI-PD is experienced as prescriptive, standardized, or compliance driven.

Autonomy emerged as both a protective value and a precondition for transformation. Faculty were open to innovation, yet resistant to mechanisms perceived as reducing professional authority. Transformative practice was considered achievable when AI-PD fostered reflective authority, ethical dialogue, and sustained engagement.

These findings suggest that AI-driven professional development functions as a mirror of institutional culture. Where trust and shared governance are present, AI-PD is perceived as augmentative and empowering. Where institutional control dominates, AI-PD risks being interpreted as regulatory rather than transformative.

RQ9: Partnerships and Institutional Implications

RQ9 investigated the issue of how faculty think their experiences of AI-based professional development should be reflected in institutional policy, PD design, and faculty-district partnerships. Respondents continually underlined that the effective implementation of sustainable AI demands structural dedication and not individual workshops. Three themes were found to be related to each other, and they included institutional supports, participatory partnerships, and policy transparency.

The participants emphasized that institutional support was essential for meaningful engagement with AI-related professional development. Time, funding, recognition, and opportunities for experimentation were consistently identified as necessary resources. Faculty viewed dedicated time, stipends, and formal recognition of innovation as indicators that their expertise and efforts were valued by the institution.

Participants also reported that trust in AI initiatives increased when institutional leaders actively engaged in AI learning themselves and communicated transparently about both the opportunities and the limitations of AI technologies. In the absence of this leadership engagement and transparency, faculty often perceived AI-related efforts as compliance-driven requirements rather than collaborative opportunities for professional growth.

Respondents expressed a preference for co-designed professional development models that allow instructors to influence content, identify discipline-specific applications, and evaluate AI tools relevant to their teaching contexts. Faculty further reported that peer mentorship networks enhanced collaboration, relevance, and accountability. They also advocated for institutional policies that address privacy, bias, accessibility, and transparency and described AI-focused professional development as a sustainable form of institutional learning when embedded within broader equity and innovation initiatives.

Cross-Cutting Insights

There were a number of cross-cutting insights across all the questions of the research. Ethical engagement was based on the foundations of trust and transparency. The conflict between compliance and autonomy influenced motivation among faculty; authentic learning provision needed agency and a meaningful choice. The context was also important because the presence of discipline, the workload, and technological availability had an impact on experiences with AI-PD. Co-creation always reinforced participation and innovation. Lastly, human-focused design based on anchoring AI in empathy, equity, and reflective practice correlated technological acceptance with transformative learning, showing that values and structure are co-determinants of the level of professional change.

Interrelationships Among Themes

Although the topics are presented separately, it is clear that they function as an interconnected system in the participants' narratives. The conditions of participation strictly define the context, which shifts the experience from compliance to

transformation. Thus, human-centered values set the boundaries of AI-PD acceptability, while ethical issues of privacy and transparency are conditions of trust without which experimentation cannot begin. Orientation in the field of innovation in education and academic integrity determines the focus of AI application but cannot replace support. Finally, co-design and structural resources link all themes into a practical logic of change.

Summary

The results indicate a complex faculty involvement in professional development based on AI. Faculty in institutions and across the disciplines have a mixed relationship between hope and apprehension regarding AI's use and its impact on ethics, workload, and institutional intent. Faculty are transformed when PD upholds autonomy, ethics, and reflection and are reduced to less enthusiasm when presented as compliance. These findings confirm the conceptual framework: The perceptions of usefulness and easy-to-use (TAM), social and institutional supports (UTAUT2), and ethical-affective factors all have a joint and positive impact on adoption. Transformative learning takes place when PD leads to critical reflection and co-creation as opposed to prescription. Chapter V explains these findings according to the theoretical framework and places them in the context of existing knowledge, suggesting implications for institutional policy, PD design, and further studies on AI-based professional learning in higher education. Table 2 summarizes the final themes and shows how each theme addresses the research questions.

Table 2

Summary of Final Themes and Their Alignment With Research Questions

Final theme	Core focus of theme	Aligned RQs	How the theme answers the RQ(s)
Theme 1: AI-driven professional development exists on a spectrum between compliance and transformation	Institutional framing of AI-PD and its perceived purpose	RQ1, RQ3	Shows the difference in the experience of the faculty depending on the framing of AI-PD as either specific mandatory compliance or opportunities in professional learning and development, with resulting effects on perceptions of effectiveness, resistance, and professional meaning
Theme 2: Faculty engagement with AI-PD is shaped more by conditions than by attitudes	Structural and contextual influences on engagement	RQ2, RQ3, RQ6	Demonstrates that the willingness of faculty to participate and to read is more dependent on time, workload, clarity, accessibility, and institutional support than on attitude to AI and aversion
Theme 3: Faculty orient toward AI in distinct way: Instructional innovation and academic integrity	Functional orientations shaping AI use and perception	RQ2, RQ4	Gives two prevailing orientations that pertain to how faculty see AI-PD, how they incorporate AI into teaching, and the way they view its effect on teaching and learning in students
Theme 4: Human-centered values serve as a boundary for AI acceptance	Alignment of AI-PD with faculty teaching values	RQ5	Shows that acceptance of AI-PD among faculty depends on how accurately it features and adheres to the human-focused motivations of equity, accessibility, relational teaching, and student support
Theme 5: Ethical concerns function as trust conditions rather than abstract principles	Ethics as relational and institutional trust	RQ7	Reveals that principles of ethics (privacy, bias, and transparency) affect how people interact with AI-PD based on the perception of institutional trust and intent and not on abstract ethical resistance
Theme 6: Faculty define effective AI-PD as co-designed, supported, and iterative	Faculty-identified conditions for meaningful AI-PD	RQ6, RQ8, RQ9	Makes faculty recommendations regarding AI-PD design; the pillars of meaningful and equitable implementation and agency, co-design, compensation, sustained learning, and structural support are fundamental

CHAPTER V

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Key Findings

This study examined faculty experiences of AI-based, AI-driven PD in academic institutions through a qualitative design based on interpretive inquiry. The main research question was the investigation of the perception of AI-based PD initiatives by the faculty, the interpretation and involvement in these initiatives, and the role of their perceptions in the relationship to technology acceptance, ethical trust, and transformative learning. The results of Chapter IV showed that some participants have had experiences of empowerment and reflective growth, and other, more compliance-based participants were influenced by institutional culture and leadership. Those findings are interpreted in this chapter in terms of transformative learning theory and the technology adoption model with the incorporation of ethical-affective constructs (Mezirow, 1991, 2000).

AI-Driven PD as Transformative or Transactional

The faculty narratives proved that AI-based PD worked as either a transformative driver or a transactional necessity. Critical reflection, experimentation, and reconsideration of pedagogical identity were some of the transformative experiences that should be identified in line with the theory of transformation in perspectives as proposed by Mezirow (1991, 2000). On the other hand, sessions driven by compliance were manifestations of instrumental participation with no meaning-making activity. The institutional framing conditioned the experiences of being empowered versus being

burdened with AI initiatives. Such findings confirm that change must be relevant and give the adult learners the power to internalize it (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). In situations where AI-PD encouraged reflection and dialogue, epistemic growth occurred; in other cases where they were forced, procedural conformity was strengthened (Knowles, 1980; Mezirow, 2000).

The institutional context had a great influence on this, in the sense that AI-based PD fostered transformation or maintained transactional compliance. Faculty working in conducive settings reported incriminating dilemmas that led to inquiry and assessment through reflection of the teaching methods, which is in line with transformative learning theory (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). Conversely, faculty working in top-down directives indicated low agency, which was reflective of the lack of agency in a restricted adult learning context (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). Such oppositional conditions indicate that transformative results rely not only on technological innovation but also on participatory cultures that authorize faculty voice and exploration (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020).

Misconceptions, Readiness, and Affective Factors

Misunderstandings of the faculty, especially the anxieties about the possibility of replacing the faculty with AI, demonstrated the lack of AI literacy and emotional preparedness. Such issues are in line with constructs of the technology acceptance model theories, whereby factors such as perceived usefulness and ease of use serve as factors determining adoption intentions (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). The more the AI was presented as being augmentative instead of substitutive, the more the preparedness increased. Emotional reactions were the primary factors of engagement direction,

including anxiety, skepticism, and curiosity. The acceptance was further mediated by trust in institutional messaging and peer modeling (Kelly et al., 2023; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Therefore, emotional considerations served as obstacles to and facilitators of involvement.

Additional factors of the variation in readiness were social influence and facilitating conditions. Faculty also described exemplar peers and open leadership communication as confidence mechanisms, which complement UTAUT2 constructs (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). On the other hand, inadequate training and lack of technical assistance increased resistance. Emotions, such as curiosity, fear, or cautious optimism, served as predictors of engagement, which supports the role of the ethical-affective focus of the recent literature (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). These results highlight the importance of AI literacy being focused on cognitive knowledge as well as coping with emotional confidence in order to facilitate sustainable adoption (Mezirow, 2000; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Human-Centered Values and Ethical Awareness

Ethical trust was found to be one of the determining criteria in faculty participation. Toleration was pegged on openness of information on privacy of data, algorithmic bias, and pedagogical honesty. Faculty reviewed AI initiatives based on often cherished teaching ideals, especially relational engagement and empathy. These results are consistent with the constructs of the ethical-affective model, which proposes that moral congruence affects motivation and comfort (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). The institutions became more open when they had clear guidelines that were articulated in terms of ethics. There was, on the other hand, uncertainty, which led to

mistrust and seclusion. The ability to accept technology was meaningless without ethical illumination (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Faculty underlined that meaningful human factors were creativity, empathy, and relational teaching, which cannot be negotiated. AI was embraced as a supporting resource and not the dictator of pedagogical dominance. According to the transformative learning theory, professional meaning-making is influenced by identity-based introspection (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). Strategic disclosure of ethical conduct ensured credibility and less perceived danger. These trends show that the adoption decision was mostly based on moral consideration rather than functional appraisal (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). Predominantly, institutions that foreshadowed collective ethical obligations developed more profound involvement and long-term participation (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020).

Faculty Agency and Institutional Dynamics

The faculty differentiated between meaningful engagement and unwilling compliance. They also appreciated PD models allowing choice, experimentation, and co-design, based on concepts of adult self-direction (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). UTAUT2 has focused on facilitating conditions as predictors of usage behavior, and the participants confirmed that time, autonomy, and recognition were found to predict long-term engagement (Venkatesh et al., 2003). Trust was undermined through mandated directives that were not consulted. Transformative learning theory also predicts autonomy as the key to perspective change (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). In this way, the institutional governance structures support or limit the agency of the faculty.

Extensive ownership and trust were regained through participatory governance. There was an increased level of institutional trust and alignment by means of faculty advisory groups, joint workshops, and joint policy development (Kelly et al., 2023; O'Meara et al., 2020). The faculty became more engaged when they perceived themselves as co-creators, as opposed to recipients of innovation. Hierarchical requirements, on the other hand, strengthened transactional involvement and emotional detachment. These results add to the current technology adoption frameworks by bringing structural power relationships into the contexts as discretionary variables (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Agency thus produces a psychological as well as an institutional construct that determines the results of AI-PD (Knowles, 1980; Mezirow, 2000).

Institutional Partnerships and Systemic Change

Faculty viewed AI-driven PD as a component of larger organizational learning and not workshops in isolation. The participants objected to the assistance of sustainable formation, including release time, funding, and recognition, and resonated with the need for institutional investment in faculty formation (Knowles, 1980; O'Meara et al., 2020). The equity aspect was particularly applicable to the adjunct faculty and the part-time faculty, as they mentioned the unavailability of resources. Transformative learning theory puts emphasis on community discourse as a significant component of community meaning-making (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). Thus, the inclusion of systemic support structures was considered a precondition of extended pedagogical novelty that would arise in the future (Kelly et al., 2023; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Discussion

Results were in close connection with the multiple conceptual frameworks that informed this research. Perceived usefulness and ease of use are central constructs in TAM, and they were found to correlate with faculty involvement (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Nevertheless, the usefulness was not sufficient to become adopted. The decisions of acceptance were mediated by ethical trust and human alignment, which supported ethical-affective dimensions (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). The PD environments that promoted reflection and autonomy led to transformative outcomes (Knowles, 1980; Mezirow, 1991). Such intersections confirm the fact that AI adoption in higher education is multidimensional and determined by cognitive, emotional, and institutional variables (Mezirow, 2000; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

By extending existing technology adoption models to AI-oriented professional development for teachers, this study makes a valuable contribution to the scientific literature. Because the analysis clearly showed that the TAM/UTAUT2 framework is insufficient to explain engagement in AI-PD without considering ethical trust and affective readiness, this provides a basis for concluding that usefulness and ease of use work only when there is transparency and trust in institutional intentions. Furthermore, the current study clarifies that transformative learning is only a conditional effect of PD design and cannot be positioned as a result of AI implementation. This fills a gap related to the lack of qualitative studies centering the voices of teachers and the criteria for meaningful change.

The UTAUT2 constructs—namely, social influence, facilitating conditions, and hedonic motivation—were also manifested in the narratives of the participants. Peer

modeling and enabling leadership positively affected involvement, whereas insufficient time and training hindered participation (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Exploration was frequently driven by the desire to explore what interested a person emotionally, and this focus on the affective motivators of efficiency was emphasized (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). These responses were placed in the context of greater changes of identity due to the AI integration within the context of the transformative learning theory (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). Collectively, these frameworks shed some light on the interaction of structural support and internal motivation (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980).

Implications

In the case of faculty development practice, the institutions need to move forward and shift out of compliance-based PD and into reflective, faculty-based ecosystems. Ethical dialogue, experimentation areas, and levels of support about digital inequities ought to be developed as components of scaffolded AI literacy training (Kelly et al., 2023; Venkatesh et al., 2003). The adult learning theories stress independence and practical significance (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). Agency and trust are strengthened through reinforcement with co-design mechanisms (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020). This type of strategy makes AI-PD more of a participatory process instead of an obligatory project (Davis, 1989; Mezirow, 1991).

Ethical transparency and inclusive governance have to be incorporated in AI frameworks through institutional policy. Openness and participatory decision-making leadership modeling help to increase credibility and willingness (Kelly et al., 2023; O'Meara et al., 2020). Release time, stipends, and recognition are pointers to institutional

devotion to innovation. Such supports are reflective of facilitating conditions that are the core of UTAUT2 (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Theoretically, in this research, technology acceptance models receive an addition of ethical-affective constructs and transformative dimensions (McGrath et al., 2023; Mezirow, 2000).

Extension of Technology Acceptance Models

Traditional technology acceptance models have adopted perceptions of usefulness and the feeling of ease of use to be the key factors in deciding upon adaptation (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Although these constructs were clear in the interviews of the faculty, the results of this study have shown that they do not provide a full-fledged explanation of engagement with AI-based professional development. The choices of the faculty did not depend only on the functional analysis of the AI tools but also on the authority structure in the institutions, professional identity, and institutional power in the participative governance. Trust in leadership transparency and shared decision-making opportunities mediated acceptance and indicated that TAM and UTAUT2 need to be combined with ethical-affective constructs (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). These findings add to the technology acceptance theory by making institutional culture and moral congruency a causal component of engagement in addition to the perceived utility (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Transformative Learning as Conditional

Transformative learning did not automatically emerge through exposure to AI technologies or participation in AI-focused workshops. Indicators of perspective transformation, including critical reflection, reassessment of professional identity, and ongoing experimentation, were observed only when professional development

experiences incorporated autonomy, disciplinary relevance, and sustained opportunities for AI exploration and application. These findings suggest that transformative learning is not an inevitable outcome of technological innovation but rather a function of intentional learning design. Such principles of adult learning as self-direction and experiential meaning-making played a crucial mediating role in the transformation (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). Thus, AI-PD needs to actively develop reflective discourse and situational practice to promote change on the identity level (Kelly et al., 2023; Mezirow, 2000).

Implications for Practice

Professional development that is driven by AI should be restructured so that it is based on compliance-oriented internationalization rather than long-term capacity building. Faculty participation was intensified as PD started working in coordination with disciplinary realities and trying to differentiate between different orientations to AI (early adopters and cautious naysayers). Favorable conditions such as time, appreciation, and technical facilities greatly contributed to continued participation (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). The conception of PD based on the genuine teaching dilemma supports the adult principles of learning that include the pretense of pertinence and independence (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). Organizations that make AI an optional resource and not an imposition establish an atmosphere that can be used to test and have faith (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020).

Ethics, Equity, and Trust

Transparency in ethics and design driven toward people became the requirements of faculty involvement. The subjects were always associated with willingness to take part

in AI-PD institutional transparency over data privacy, algorithmic biases, and instructional integrity. Ethical considerations do not serve as positions of abstract philosophical dedication; instead, they are practical institutional procedures that produce trust (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). Consideration of equity issues was especially relevant to adjunct and part-time faculty when PD resources had less access to participation. The individual use of technology acceptance constructs does not explain these differences, which makes the incorporation of justice-focused frameworks into the models of adoption a necessity (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Ethics have to be operationalized in this way to establish inclusive accessibility, transparent policies, and participatory dialogue (Kelly et al., 2023; O'Meara et al., 2020).

Leadership and Policy Implications

Faculty agency, such as involvement in AI management, became an important leading approach. The possibility of co-designing AI policies or PD efforts by faculty substantially contributed to improving trust and engagement. This is in line with studies that have highlighted the application of shared governance in promoting organizational commitment (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020). Leadership openness and concrete investments, such as release time, stipend, and acknowledgement, were indicators of institutional gravity in the context of AI innovation. These cues interrelate with enabling the conditions that UTAUT2 is based on (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). The policy frameworks entrenching ethical protections and faculty representation enhance adoption and morale (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023).

Implications for Future Research

Future studies should look at co-designed AI-PD models to establish the effects of the structure on engagement and instructional change overall. Longitudinal research is especially required to determine whether original curiosity is converted into long-term pedagogical change (Mezirow, 2000; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Different disciplines and types of appointments can be compared, potentially identifying some structural bias in access and perception (Kelly et al., 2023; O'Meara et al., 2020). In addition, considering student perspectives would put faculty adoption in wider educational ecosystems. Theoretical integration may be further perfected by quantitative validation of constructs of ethical trust and affective acceptance within TAM and UTAUT2 models (Davis, 1989; McGrath et al., 2023).

Limitations

The study utilized a small, purposive sample of faculty from a single community college district and relied primarily on self-reported perceptions and experiences. As a qualitative study, the intent was to develop a rich understanding of participants' experiences rather than produce findings that are statistically generalizable to broader populations (Creswell & Poth, 2018; Merriam & Tisdell, 2016). Additionally, participant responses may have been influenced by social desirability bias, particularly given the rapidly evolving nature of institutional conversations surrounding artificial intelligence. Changes in institutional policies, professional development opportunities, and AI technologies during the study period may also have shaped participants' perceptions and experiences.

Recommendations for Future Research

Recommendations for Institutions

Institutions could create an AI-PD toolkit based on the principles of human-centered and ethical design. This toolkit would be designed to incorporate technical instructions together with reflective questions, case studies, and ethical scenario analysis in order to assist in making well-informed choices. Baselines of AI activity in clarity and the transparency of moral issues increase trust and participation (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). In addition, institutions should incorporate usability considerations and ethical safeguards into AI-related professional development initiatives. Aligning these efforts with the technology acceptance constructs of perceived usefulness and facilitating conditions may strengthen faculty trust, engagement, and adoption of AI tools (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). A holistic toolkit guarantees uniformity and sensitivity of context in interdepartmental flexibility.

It is also essential not to disregard co-design principles by embedding them in the faculty advisory groups. Between faculty involvement in planning and governance, there are advantages such as promoting ownership and alleviating the feeling of top-down imposition. Shared governance systems contribute to institutional trust and optimization of innovation and professional identity (Mezirow, 2000; O'Meara et al., 2020). AI-PD is a participatory process of learning when faculty are utilized as partners and not recipients of reform. This practice is also consistent with the principles of the adult learning theory that emphasizes autonomy and experience as being relevant (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980). Co-design thus enhances the validity of every policy as well as its practical application.

AI literacy must be incorporated into every program of professional development in institutions with equity considerations at their core. Preparedness among faculty differs greatly based on the discipline and type of appointment, as well as previous exposure to technologies. Inclusive engagement can be promoted through scaffolded learning encompassing the learners and basic concepts of AI, ethical considerations, and application of AI in pedagogy (Kelly et al., 2023; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Structural disparities in participation may be neutralized by equity-induced approaches such as stipends, flexible schedules, or adjunct access (Davis, 1989; O'Meara et al., 2020). Making AI literacy a sustained competency as opposed to a workshop will aid a long-term capacity-building approach.

AI-PD initiatives should also be included with reflection-based assessment mechanisms. Peer mentoring models, narrative reflective models, and faculty portfolios provide guided exploration of the integration of AI in teaching. Transformative learning theory has emphasized the role of reflection and dialogue in bringing perspective transformation (Mezirow, 1991, 2000). These self-reflective systems bring evaluation outside the sphere of procedural conformity to that of identity building. Mentoring communities also enhance the social influence and collaborative inquiry that facilitate conditions that result in adoption (Knowles, 1980; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Lastly, the institutions should produce data privacy and ethics-usage principles that are co-authored by the faculty. Open policies dealing with investor bias in the algorithms, student data security, and property rights elucidate institutional promise and minimize ambiguity. Ethical frameworks are operational practices that influence the decisions of engagement (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). The shared authorship

strengthens the trust and participatory governance in the sense of organizational commitment and technology acceptance studies (Davis, 1989; O'Meara et al., 2020).

Faculty Developer and Practitioner Recommendations

Faculty developers should provide discipline-specific AI learning modules that align with curricular goals, disciplinary standards, and professional practice. Personalized examples increase faculty perceptions of relevance and usefulness, thereby supporting meaningful integration of AI into teaching and learning (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Discipline-based framing also supports contextualized learning, a key principle of adult learning theory (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Knowles, 1980).

Faculty developers are further encouraged to create learning communities where instructors can share practical applications, discuss challenges, and collaboratively explore ethical implications of AI use. Such peer exchanges promote reflective dialogue and collective learning, both of which are central to transformative learning processes (Kelly et al., 2023; Mezirow, 2000).

Faculty anxiety and uncertainty regarding AI adoption may be further reduced through the use of safe experimentation spaces, often referred to as sandbox environments. These environments encourage exploration and innovation without evaluative pressure, allowing faculty to develop confidence in their use of AI tools. In turn, sandbox environments support professional autonomy, experimentation, and the ongoing development of faculty identity as educators in an AI-enhanced learning environment (O'Meara et al., 2020; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Practice and Future Research Recommendations

The AI-PD toolkit designed by the institutions must be based on ethical, human-centered design principles (Kelly et al., 2023; McGrath et al., 2023). Planning processes can be implemented through faculty advisory groups that can instill co-design, which empowers the participatory forms of governance (Knowles, 1980; O'Meara et al., 2020). Transformative meaning-making is encouraged with the help of reflection-based portfolios and mentoring communities (Hase & Kenyon, 2000; Mezirow, 1991). Having clear rules of data privacy that are co-authored with the faculty inspires trust (Davis, 1989; Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Future studies may address the longitudinal effects of AI-PD on instructional practice and identity development (Kelly et al., 2023; Mezirow, 2000). Within the framework of comparative studies between various fields and types of appointment, it may be possible to identify structural inequities in access (O'Meara et al., 2020; Venkatesh et al., 2003). Theoretical integration would be enhanced by the quantitative validity of constructs of ethical trust in TAM and UTAUT2 models (Davis, 1989; McGrath et al., 2023). The attitudes of students toward AI-mediated instruction should be investigated in a way that enables the contextualization of faculty adoption within the broader educational ecosystem (Knowles, 1980; Mezirow, 1991).

Summary

This study explored faculty perceptions of AI-powered professional development in a qualitative context and found that AI implementation in higher education is defined by ethics, emotion, and institutional culture (as much as technical functionality). Faculty did not equate AI-PD with an institutional statement of values, trust, and professional

identity, but rather with technological innovation. In cases where efforts were open, participatory, and based on the principles of adult learning, they led to and nurtured agency, reflective development, and impactful change in the instructional practice. Conversely, the compliance-based or unsupported implementations increased doubt and transactional interaction.

The results confirm that the perceived usefulness and ease of use still provide contextual predictions on engagement, but they are not facets that can work alone without the presence of ethical trust, emotional preparedness, and meaningful involvement in decision-making. Facilitating conditions, peer modeling, and transparency in leadership had a significant influence on faculty acceptance. Curiosity, anxiety, resistance, and optimism are emotional reactions that acted as excellent mediators of adoption. Transformative learning was achieved as faculty received an invitation to critically contemplate the role of AI in education and to ground its use in accordance with their values of human-centered teaching.

In sum, the study contributes a multidimensional model of AI integration in professional development to integrate the theory of technology acceptance with ethical-affective and transformative models of learning. AI-based PD can be successful through its focus on efficiency, but it also needs to consider empathy, autonomy, and shared governance. By focusing on the voice of the faculty and its moral congruency, the institutions may be able to move out of mere compliance and toward sustainable innovations that empower the practice of instruction and organizational trust.

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APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

FACULTY INTERVIEW PROTOCOL

Title: From Compliance to Transformation: Faculty Perspectives on AI-Driven Professional Development

Purpose: This interview protocol is designed to explore how higher-education faculty perceive and experience AI-driven professional development, specifically how AI-based tools, training formats, and institutional approaches influence teaching practice, ethics, and transformation in higher education.

Instructions to Participants: You are invited to share your personal reflections and experiences with AI-driven PD. You may respond to these questions in one of two ways:

- Written Interview: Complete the questions using the secure Google Form provided.
- Optional Live Interview: Participate in a one-on-one session (via Zoom or in person) using the same questions.

Each question encourages open reflection; there are no right or wrong answers. You may skip any question or stop participation at any time.

Estimated Time: 45-60 minutes

Introduction and Consent Statement: Welcome, and thank you for participating in this study conducted by Reyna Trujillo, a doctoral candidate in the University of La Verne's LaFetra College of Education.

The purpose of this study is to understand how faculty experience various forms of professional development (PD) related to artificial intelligence, including:

- General PD: Traditional learning and growth opportunities for educators.
- AI-Driven PD: PD enhanced or delivered through AI tools and platforms.
- AI PD: PD that specifically teaches about AI integration and educational use.

- AI Literacy: Developing the skills needed to evaluate, use, and critique AI responsibly.

This research focuses on how faculty define effectiveness, human-centered values, and lasting impact in AI-related PD. It also explores whether PD experiences feel compliance-driven or transformative and how those perceptions affect teaching and student outcomes. Participation is voluntary. You may decline to answer any question or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty. Your responses are confidential. If you choose a live interview, audio or video recording will occur only with your explicit consent. All responses will be securely stored in the researcher's University of La Verne OneDrive and retained for three (3) years following data collection. Any audio or video recordings will be permanently deleted after transcription. Only the researcher and dissertation committee will have access to data.

Interview Questions

Section A. Background & Context

1. What is your current teaching role? (adjunct, full-time, part-time, administrator, other)
2. How many years have you worked in higher education?
3. Which division or discipline do you primarily teach in?
4. Age range (25-34, 35-44, 45-54, 55-64
5. Gender identity (open response)

Section B. Experiences & Effectiveness

6. How does your institution currently approach professional development (compliance-driven, optional, innovative)? Where does AI-related PD fit within that approach?
7. When you hear the term "AI-driven professional development," what does it mean to you, and what experiences have you had with it (if any)?
8. How does AI-related PD compare with traditional PD you have experienced?
9. Can you share one example of PD that felt primarily compliance-driven and one that felt more transformative or growth-oriented? What made them feel that way?
10. What influence, if any, has AI-related PD had on your teaching practices and your students' learning or success?

Section C. Human-Centered Values, Equity & Ethics

11. To what extent does AI-related PD align (or misalign) with your teaching values and disciplinary context?
12. Do you feel AI-related PD is equally accessible and relevant across different groups of faculty? Why or why not?
13. Do you feel AI-PD is equally relevant across different disciplines, or are some fields better served than others?
14. What ethical considerations matter most to you in AI-related PD, and how do these shape your willingness to engage?

Section D. Readiness, Agency, & Misconceptions

15. How ready or confident do you feel to engage with AI-related PD, and what barriers or supports shape that readiness?

16. What misconceptions or uncertainties (in yourself or among colleagues) do you notice about AI or AI-PD? How do these affect participation or resistance?
17. How do you experience AI-PD in relation to institutional requirements and opportunities for growth?

Section E. Lasting Impact & Future Vision

18. What institutional supports or actions (resources, leadership, policies, incentives) would make AI-PD more meaningful, equitable, and trustworthy for you?

Thank you for contributing your voice to this study. Your reflections help illuminate how faculty experience AI-driven professional development and what truly supports growth, equity, and innovation. I deeply appreciate the time and thought you invested in sharing your experiences.

APPENDIX B

CONSENT TO PARTICIPATE IN RESEARCH FORM

University of La Verne IRB-Approved Consent Statement

Title of Study: From Compliance to Transformation: Faculty Perspectives on AI-Driven Professional Development

Researcher: Reyna Trujillo, Doctoral Candidate, University of La Verne, LaFetra College of Education

Faculty Chair: Dr. Martin Yousef, LaFetra College of Education

CONSENT TO PARTICIPATE IN RESEARCH

FROM COMPLIANCE TO TRANSFORMATION: FACULTY PERSPECTIVES ON AI-DRIVEN PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Key Information: This study contributes to the doctoral dissertation of Reyna Trujillo at the University of La Verne and may also be used for future publication or presentation. The purpose of this research is to explore how higher-education faculty perceive and experience AI-driven professional development (PD) and how these perceptions influence engagement, teaching practices, and student outcomes. You may participate if you are currently employed as higher-education faculty, are age 18 or older, and have participated in or been exposed to professional-development activities within your institution.

If you choose to participate, you may select one of two options for completing the interview:

- Written Interview: respond to approximately 18 open-ended questions through a secure Google Form at your convenience, or
- Optional Live Interview: Take part in a 45-60 minute one-on-one conversation (via Zoom or in person) using the same 18 questions.

There will be no follow-up interviews or additional data collection beyond this single session. Audio or video recording will occur only with your explicit consent.

There are no anticipated major risks to participation. The most foreseeable risk may involve mild discomfort when reflecting on professional experiences or discussing perspectives about AI. Your confidentiality will be safeguarded through de-identification of all responses, encrypted storage on the University of La Verne OneDrive, and restricted access limited to the researcher and dissertation committee. Data will be retained for three (3) years following study completion and then permanently deleted.

Although you may not receive direct personal benefit, your participation may offer an opportunity to reflect on your own professional-development experiences. More broadly, your insights may help institutions design PD that integrates AI ethically, equitably, and effectively.

Participation is voluntary. You may withdraw at any time or skip any question without penalty. There is no payment or other compensation for participation. Your employment status or professional standing will not be affected by your decision to participate or by anything you share. You are not waiving any legal rights by agreeing to participate.

INTRODUCTION

You are invited to participate in an IRB-approved research study conducted by Reyna Trujillo, a doctoral candidate in the LaFetra College of Education at the University of La Verne. This study contributes to a doctoral dissertation and may also be used for future publications or presentations. The purpose of this research is to explore how higher-education faculty perceive and experience AI-driven professional development (PD) and

how these perceptions influence engagement, teaching practices, and student outcomes. The study focuses on the usefulness, ethical considerations, and human-centered impact of AI tools in faculty learning and growth.

If you choose to participate, you will be invited to complete a written interview consisting of 18 open-ended questions via a secure Google Form, or you may choose to participate in a one-on-one interview (via Zoom or in person) using the same questions. Each session or written submission will take approximately 45-60 minutes. Participation in this study involves minimal risk, such as mild discomfort while reflecting on professional experiences. All responses will be confidential and stored securely on the University of La Verne OneDrive for three (3) years, accessible only to the researcher and dissertation committee.

Your participation is voluntary. You may skip any question, decline recording, or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty or loss of benefits.

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The purpose of this qualitative study is to explore how higher-education faculty perceive and experience AI-driven professional development and how these perceptions influence engagement, teaching practice, and support for student success. Grounded in the Technology Acceptance Model, the Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology and transformative learning theory, this study centers on faculty voices and ethical-affective dimensions of technology adoption. Methodologically, the research employs a single-phase qualitative design using an 18-question interview protocol with faculty across the Los Angeles Community College District. Findings will contribute to both scholarship and practice by offering actionable insights for designing ethical, effective, and human-

centered professional development programs that integrate artificial intelligence responsibly.

PROCEDURES

You are invited to participate in one individual interview exploring your experiences and perspectives on AI-driven professional development in higher education. You may select one of two participation options:

- Written Interview: Complete 18 open-ended questions independently via a secure Google Form.
- Optional Live Interview: Participate in a 45-60-minute one-on-one conversation (via Zoom or in person) using the same questions.

You will be asked to reflect on your experiences, institutional practices, and views about how AI impacts teaching, learning, and faculty growth. Participation is entirely voluntary. You may skip any question or withdraw from the study at any time without penalty.

SURVEY PARTICIPATION

All higher education faculty members, including adjunct, full-time, tenure-track, and tenured faculty, are invited to participate in an interview. The survey is anonymous and voluntary.

LENGTH AND TIMING

Your total time commitment will be approximately 45-60 minutes, depending on your selected participation format (written or live). All interviews consist of 18 open-ended questions that invite reflection on the usefulness, ethics, human-centered values, and transformative potential of AI-enhanced professional development.

CONFIDENTIALITY AND VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

All participation is voluntary, and you may skip any question or withdraw at any time without penalty. Your responses will be confidential and identified only by a numeric ID code. All data, including written responses, transcripts, or recordings, will be de-identified during analysis. With your permission, audio or video recordings may be made during live interviews to ensure transcription accuracy. Recordings will be securely stored in the researcher's University of La Verne OneDrive account and permanently deleted after verified transcription. De-identified data will be stored for three (3) years following completion of the study, after which all digital files will be deleted, and any printed materials will be shredded.

ACCESSIBILITY AND ACCOMMODATIONS

The written interview (Google Form) is screen-reader compatible, and interview materials are available in large print or other accessible formats upon request. Closed captioning will be available for Zoom interviews, and additional accommodations can be provided as needed. There is no payment or compensation for participating in this study. Your decision to participate or not will have no impact on your employment or standing at your institution.

Please initial next to your selection:

[__] I consent to be [*state either audio or video*] recorded

_____

[__] I do not give my consent to be [*state either audio or video*] recorded

_____

POTENTIAL RISKS AND DISCOMFORTS

All research procedures in this study follow the highest ethical standards as outlined by the University of La Verne Institutional Review Board (IRB) and the CITI Program for human-subjects protection. Participation involves minimal risk. The most foreseeable discomfort may arise from reflecting on personal experiences or expressing opinions about institutional professional development practices. To minimize these risks, you may skip any question, pause at any point, or withdraw from the study without penalty. All collected data will be confidential and stored on encrypted, password-protected systems. Each participant will be assigned a unique ID code. Only the principal investigator (PI), Reyna Trujillo, and the approved dissertation committee members (Dr. Martin C. Yousef, Dr. Amanda Ryan-Romo, and Dr. Michelle Yanez) will have access to the data. Data will be retained for three (3) years following completion of the study and then permanently deleted. Although this study poses minimal risk, participants who experience discomfort may request referrals to campus counseling or wellness services.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS TO PARTICIPANTS AND/OR TO SOCIETY

While there may be no direct personal benefit, participants may find value in reflecting on their experiences with AI-driven professional development and in considering how emerging technologies shape teaching and learning. At the institutional level, insights from this study may help colleges design professional development programs that are more human-centered, ethical, and effective. At a broader level, the findings may contribute to policies and practices supporting equitable, responsible, and transformative use of AI in higher education.

PAYMENT FOR PARTICIPATION

There is no payment or other form of compensation for participation. Taking part is entirely voluntary. You may withdraw at any time or skip any question without consequence. The investigator may withdraw a participant only under unforeseen circumstances. Participation does not waive any legal rights.

EXTENDED CARE OPTIONS FOR MORE THAN MINIMAL RISK RESEARCH

This study involves no more than minimal risk. The slight possibility of discomfort from self-reflection is outweighed by the value of contributing to a greater understanding of how AI-driven PD can support meaningful, ethical faculty learning. Risks are minimized through clear consent procedures, voluntary participation, and secure data handling. Participants may stop or skip questions at any time. Sensitive topics will be approached with care, and all data will be de-identified and securely stored.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Confidentiality will be maintained through strict data management and security protocols. Each participant will be assigned a unique ID code, and names or identifying information will not appear in any report or publication. Written interview responses will be collected via Google Forms (University of La Verne account) and securely stored on University of La Verne OneDrive. Audio or video recordings (if applicable) will be made only with explicit participant consent. Participants may review or edit their transcripts before analysis. Transcription will be completed by the principal investigator or a secure university-approved transcription service. Once transcriptions are verified, all recordings will be permanently deleted. De-identified data and consent forms will be retained for three (3) years after completion of data collection, after which all digital data will be permanently

deleted and any physical materials shredded. No information will be released to any third party unless required by law or with your written permission.

PARTICIPATION AND WITHDRAWAL

Your participation in this study is completely voluntary. You may choose not to participate or to withdraw at any time without penalty or loss of benefits. You may also refuse to answer specific questions while remaining in the study. If circumstances arise that warrant withdrawal, the investigator may discontinue your participation, but this would occur only under unforeseen conditions.

IDENTIFICATION OF INVESTIGATORS AND CONTACTS FOR QUESTIONS

If you have any questions or concerns about the research, please feel free to contact research personnel:

Reyna Trujillo, Faculty Sponsor/Chair Dr. Martin Yousef at trujilr2@laccd.edu or myousef@laverne.edu

RIGHTS OF RESEARCH PARTICIPANTS

You may withdraw your consent at any time and discontinue participation without penalty. You are not waiving any legal claims, rights, or remedies because of your participation in this research study. If you have questions regarding your rights as a research participant, or if you are injured while participating in the study, please contact the IRB Office at 909-448-4564 (irb@laverne.edu), University of La Verne, Institutional Review Board, 1950 3rd Street, La Verne, CA 91750.

SIGNATURE OF RESEARCH PARTICIPANT OR LEGAL REPRESENTATIVE

I understand the procedures described above. My questions have been answered to my satisfaction, and I agree to participate in this study. I am over the age of 18 years and have been given a copy of this form.

_____

Printed Name of Participant

_____

Printed Name of Legal Representative (if applicable)

_____ _____

Signature of Participant or Legal Representative Date

SIGNATURE OF INVESTIGATOR (If required by the IRB)

In my judgement the participant is voluntarily and knowingly giving informed consent and possesses the legal capacity to give informed consent to participate in this research study.

_____ _____

Signature of Investigator Date

APPENDIX C

RECRUITMENT COMMUNICATIONS

Pre/Post Email Invitation Template:

Subject: Invitation to Participate — Doctoral Study on AI-Driven Professional Development

Dear [Faculty Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am inviting you to participate in my doctoral research study at the University of La Verne titled *From Compliance to Transformation: Faculty Perspectives on AI-Driven Professional Development.*

The purpose of this study is to explore how higher-education faculty experience and perceive professional development that integrates artificial intelligence (AI). I am seeking approximately ten faculty members across the Los Angeles Community College District who are willing to share their experiences and reflections. Participation involves responding to 18 open-ended questions about your experiences with AI-related professional development. You may choose one of two participation options:

- Written Interview: Complete the questions online through a secure Google Form at your convenience.
- Optional Live Interview: Participate in a 45-60-minute one-on-one conversation (via Zoom or in person) using the same questions.

Your participation is voluntary and confidential**.** You may skip any question or withdraw at any time. With consent, live interviews may be audio- or video-recorded; recordings will be deleted after transcription. All data will be stored securely in University of La Verne OneDrive for three years and then permanently deleted.

If you are interested in participating or would like more information, please reply to this email or contact me directly at trujilr2@laccd.edu**.** I will send you the consent form and interview link or coordinate a convenient interview time.

Thank you for considering this opportunity to contribute your voice to a study focused on supporting faculty growth and meaningful, human-centered professional development.

Warm regards,

Reyna Trujillo

Doctoral Candidate, EdD in Educational Leadership

University of La Verne | LaFetra College of Education

trujilr2@laccd.edu

Subject: Thank You for Participating in My Doctoral Study

Dear [Participant Name],

I want to sincerely thank you for taking the time to participate in my doctoral research study, *From Compliance to Transformation: Faculty Perspectives on AI-Driven Professional Development*. Your insights and reflections are invaluable in helping illuminate how faculty experience AI-driven professional development and what makes these opportunities meaningful and transformative.

All information you shared will remain confidential and will be used only for research purposes in accordance with University of La Verne IRB and CITI guidelines. De-identified data will be securely stored in ULV OneDrive for three years before deletion.

If you would like to receive a summary of the study findings once it is complete, or if you would like to review your transcript for accuracy, please let me know, and I will be happy to share that with you.

Thank you again for contributing your voice to this research and for your ongoing commitment to advancing teaching and learning in higher education.

Warm regards,

Reyna Trujillo

Doctoral Candidate, EdD in Educational Leadership

University of La Verne, LaFetra College of Education

trujilr2@laccd.edu

APPENDIX D

IRB APPLICATIONS

D.1 University of La Verne IRB Application Summary (Initial Submission)

- IRB Type: Non-Intervention, Adult Participants
- Study Title: *From Compliance to Transformation: Faculty Perspectives on AI-Driven Professional Development*
- Approval Status: Approved October 2025
- IRB ID:
- Key Updates: 18-question interview; written/Zoom format; 3-year data retention.

D.2 Los Angeles Community College District (LACCD) IRB Application Summary

- LACCD Research Oversight Committee: Submission for Site Authorization
- Alignment: LACCD policy for non-intervention, minimal risk studies
- Approval Status: Pending
- Notes: No student data collected; faculty participants only; data anonymized and securely stored.

APPENDIX E

DATA SECURITY AND RETENTION STATEMENT

Storage Location: All data will be stored on University of La Verne OneDrive, protected by multifactor authentication and encryption. Google Form responses were transferred immediately to OneDrive and deleted from the form database.

De-identification Process: Each participant was assigned a unique alphanumeric ID.

- Names and institutional identifiers were removed during transcription.
- Any potentially identifying metadata (Zoom, file names, email references) is deleted upon verification.

Access:

- Only the principal investigator (Reyna Trujillo) and dissertation committee members have access to the data.
- No third-party transcription services were used.

Retention and Destruction:

- De-identified data is retained for three years post-study completion.
- After three years, all files were permanently deleted, and physical documents were shredded.
- Participants may request confirmation of data deletion.

APPENDIX F

FINAL CODEBOOK (VERSION 2)

Purpose of the Codebook: This codebook records the completed analytic codes on the thematic analysis of faculty-written interview responses. The development of codes was done in an iterative way that is aligned with the six-phase reflexive thematic analysis presented by Braun and Clarke (2021). The first codes (v1) were created inductively by close reading of the participants' stories and narrowed down with the help of constant comparison, writing analytic memos, and matching it to the conceptual boundaries of the study. Version 2 is the final analytic scheme applied to produce the themes that are reported in Chapter 4. The codes consist of a definition, inclusion, excluded criteria, and analysis notes in order to uphold transparency and reliability.

A. PD Culture & Framing

1. COMPLIANCE DRIVEN PD

Definition:

Professional development as described by the faculty was approached in terms of being mandatory, procedural, and usually devoted to institutional needs rather than learning.

Include when:

- PD is described as "required," "mandated," "checkbox," or compliance-related.
- Emphasis is on completion, policy acknowledgment, flex hours, or reporting.

Exclude when:

- Faculty describe voluntary, reflective, or practice-based learning.

Analytic Notes:

Captures institutional framing rather than faculty attitude. Often co-occurs with disengagement but does not imply resistance to learning itself.

2. GROWTH ORIENTED PD

Definition:

Faculty descriptions of PD experienced as meaningful, reflective, iterative, or connected to teaching practice.

Include when:

- PD involves experimentation, dialogue, application, or reflection.
- Faculty describe learning as professionally enriching or transformative.

Exclude when:

- PD is described only in terms of attendance or obligation.

Analytic Notes:

Object-oriented on the signs of transformative learning yet strictly on the language used by the participants instead of theory.

3. PD MARKETING CLARITY

Definition:

The perception towards the clarity of the AI-PD offerings as perceived by the faculties, labeled, and differentiated.

Include when:

- Mentions of unclear descriptions, sporadic announcements, or confusion about level/audience
- Difficulty determining relevance or expectations

Exclude when:

- Critiques focus solely on PD content rather than communication.

Analytic Notes:

Often functions as a hidden barrier to participation and readiness.

B. AI-PD Meaning & Use

4. AI PD MEANING

Definition:

How faculty define or interpret “AI-driven professional development” in their own terms.

Include when:

- Faculty describe AI-PD as tools training, literacy, integrity training, policy response, or instructional design.
- Definitions vary across participants.

Exclude when:

- Faculty discuss AI use unrelated to PD.

Analytic Notes:

The difference in definitions is not confused, but it is treated as data and educates preparedness and involvement.

5. PERCEIVED USEFULNESS

Definition:

Perceptions of faculty that AI or AI-PD enhances efficiency, quality of teaching, organization, or instructional design.

Include when:

- AI is described as saving time, improving feedback, enhancing materials, or supporting instruction.

Exclude when:

- Statements focus only on concerns, risks, or skepticism.

Analytic Notes:

Related to technology acceptance models but interpreted as contingent on context and conditions.

6. STRUCTURAL BARRIERS

Definition:

Institutional or logistical factors that limit faculty participation in AI-PD.

Include when:

- Mentions of time constraints, workload, scheduling, unpaid labor
- Adjunct or noncredit access issues

Exclude when:

- Barriers are framed purely as personal disinterest.

Analytic Notes:

Resistance frequently reflects rational constraints rather than negative attitudes toward AI.

7. FACILITATING CONDITIONS

Definition:

Institutional supports that enable or encourage engagement with AI-PD.

Include when:

- Access to tools, licenses, and IT support
- Structured PD pathways or series

Exclude when:

- Faculty describe informal or self-created supports only.

Analytic Notes:

Frequently combined with perceived usefulness; lack of either of them undermines engagement.

C. Human-Centered Values & Equity

8. HUMAN CENTERED ALIGNMENT

Definition:

Faculty perceptions that AI-PD aligns with values such as empathy, equity, accessibility, and relational teaching.

Include when:

- AI is described as supporting students, inclusion, or care.
- Emphasis on student-centered or values-based teaching

Exclude when:

- Values are mentioned abstractly without connection to AI-PD.

Analytic Notes:

Works as a limitation of acceptance but not as a universal preference.

9. HUMAN CENTERED M

Definition:

The opinion of faculty that AI-PD poses a danger or a threat to human-centered teaching values.

Include when:

- AI is described as dehumanizing, impersonal, automated, or replacing teaching craft.
- Concerns about loss of voice or relational teaching

Exclude when:

- Critiques focus only on technical limitations.

Analytic Notes:

Sometimes they are indicators of moral or identity-based uneasiness instead of opposition to technology as an idea.

10. EQUITY ACCESS G

Definition:

Faculty view of equal access to AI-PD regardless of role, programs, or disciplines.

Include when:

- Mentions of adjunct/noncredit inequities
- Time-pay mismatches or under-resourced programs

Exclude when:

- General complaints not tied to equity or access

Analytic Notes:

Highlights systemic rather than individual barriers.

D. Ethics, Trust, and Risk

11. ETHICAL TRUST CONCERNS

Definition:

Faculty issues pertaining to privacy, prejudice, transparency, surveillance, or institutional will.

Include when:

- Mentions of data use, fairness, algorithmic bias, monitoring
- Expressions of mistrust tied to AI adoption

Exclude when:

- Ethical terms are hypothetical or detached from institutional practice.

Analytic Notes:

Ethics function as trust conditions rather than abstract moral positions.

12. ACADEMIC INTEGRITY ORIENTATION

Definition:

Faculty worries about AI, mostly via cheating, plagiarism, or test administration.

Include when:

- AI is discussed mainly as a risk to integrity.
- Emphasis on detection, prevention, or redesign to avoid misuse

Exclude when:

- AI is discussed primarily as instructional support.

Analytic Notes:

One of two functional orientations toward AI; not treated as resistant or inferior.

13. JOB DISPLACEMENT FEAR

Definition:

Faculty worry about AI abolishing professors, eliminating human labor, or being used as a cost-saving measure.

Include when:

- Mentions of automation replacing teaching or faculty roles
- Cost-saving narratives tied to AI adoption

Exclude when:

- General skepticism without labor implications

Analytic Notes:

Closely tied to institutional trust and governance concerns.

E. Agency, Voice, and Transformation

14. FACULTY AGENCY

Definition:

Faculty freedom of expression of autonomy, choice, ownership, or control in its interaction with AI-PD.

Include when:

- Mentions of freedom to experiment or self-directed learning
- Preference for opt-in or co-designed PD

Exclude when:

- Agency is discussed abstractly or unrelated to AI-PD.

Analytic Notes:

Central to the compliance-transformation distinction.

15. FACULTY VOICE GOVERNANCE

Definition:

Professional mentions of participating (or not) in AI-related institutional decision-making processes, anticipation, policy, or PD priorities.

Include when:

- Mentions of shared governance, consultation, transparency
- Frustration with top-down AI decisions or mandates

Exclude when:

- Agency refers only to personal experimentation.

Analytic Notes:

Links agency to trust and institutional intent, which is critical for leadership implications.

16. TRANSFORMATIVE INDICATORS

Definition:

Evidence of perspective shift, reflective change, or rethinking teaching practices.

Include when:

- Faculty describe changed assumptions, redesigned assessments, or new approaches.
- Language indicates learning beyond skill acquisition.

Exclude when:

- Statements describe use without reflection.

Analytic Notes:

Used cautiously, presence indicates potential transformation, not a guaranteed outcome.

F. Desired AI-PD Design Features

17. DESIRED PD DESIGN FEATURES

Definition:

Faculty recommendations for improving AI-PD design and implementation.

Include when:

- Requests for stipends, sandbox environments, modular series
- Calls for discipline-specific or co-designed PD

Exclude when:

- General complaints without constructive suggestions

Analytic Notes:

Forms the foundation for institutional and policy implications in Chapter 5.

APPENDIX G

UNCODING

What the data is "saying" before you label it

Across responses, faculty are repeatedly doing six things:

1. **Defining AI-PD in their own terms** (tools training, policy response, integrity training, instructional design, "admin hype," or "just another tech trend").
2. **Judging AI-PD by how it feels in practice** (hands-on and relevant vs. generic, performative, or "checkbox" compliance).
3. **Naming the central tension**: *capacity-building and innovation* vs. *cheating, surveillance, dehumanization, and job displacement.*
4. **Drawing boundaries around professional identity and human teaching** (teaching as a relational craft; concern about standardization, automation, or loss of voice).
5. **Pointing to inequities of access and feasibility** (time, workload, adjunct/noncredit compensation, scheduling, licenses/tools, and uneven support).
6. **Calling out governance and institutional intent** (who decides, transparency, trust, cost-cutting narratives, and faculty voice in AI expectations and PD design).

Working storyline: Faculty do not experience AI-PD as "good" or "bad" by default. They experience it as either a meaningful professional learning pathway or an institutional control/cost-saving response, with *conditions (time, access, clarity, trust, and faculty voice)* acting as the lever.

2) STARTER CODEBOOK (First-Cycle Codes)

A clean, defensible scaffolding for initial coding (not your final themes).

A. PD Culture: Compliance vs. Growth

- **COMPLIANCE PD**. Required trainings, “checkbox,” mandated hours, policy acknowledgment, cybersecurity/Canvas-type compliance framing
- **GROWTH PD** - learning communities, coaching, practice-based PD, reflection/iteration
- **PD MARKETING CLARITY** - unclear descriptions, sporadic announcements, hard to choose the “right level,” inconsistent audience targeting

B. AI-PD Meaning & Use (TAM/UTAUT-adjacent)

- **AI PD DEFINITION** - how faculty define AI-PD (tools, literacy, policy response, integrity, instructional design)
- **PERCEIVED USEFULNESS** - saves time, improves materials/feedback/organization, supports instruction
- **EFFORT TIME COST** - workload/time barrier, cognitive load, scheduling friction
- **FACILITATING CONDITIONS** - tools access, licenses, IT support, VRC/Vision Resource Center, structured pathways, training supports
- **SOCIAL INFLUENCE** - peer modeling, early adopters, informal communities, leadership framing, and norms

C. Human-Centered Values & Equity

- **HUMAN CENTERED ALIGNMENT** - empathy, accessibility, multilingual/ESL scaffolds, relational teaching, student support
- **HUMAN CENTERED MISALIGNMENT** - dehumanization concerns, loss of voice/craft, over-standardization, impersonal teaching/learning

- **DISCIPLINE FIT** - “some disciplines better served”; humanities/Spanish/ESL need adaptation; context-specific applicability
- **EQUITY ACCESS GAP** - adjunct/noncredit inequities; unpaid time; under-resourced programs; uneven tool access

D. Ethics, Trust, and Risk

- **PRIVACY DATA** - student/faculty data protection; tool policies; uncertainty about data storage/use
- **BIAS FAIRNESS** - bias, discrimination, inequity reproduction, transparency concerns
- **ACADEMIC INTEGRITY** - cheating, plagiarism, “AI-as-shortcut,” assessment control
- **INSTITUTIONAL INTENT MISTRUST** - skepticism, “eye-rolling,” admin hype, performative modernity, surveillance/cost-cutting narratives
- **JOB DISPLACEMENT FEAR** - AI replacing faculty/staff; labor substitution; virtual/automated instruction concerns
- **SUSTAINABILITY CONCERN** - environmental/energy/water use concerns (code if present; treat as minor but meaningful)

E. Agency, Voice, and Transformation

- **FACULTY AGENCY**. Autonomy, sandboxing, freedom to experiment, opt-in preference, professional judgment
- **FACULTY VOICE GOVERNANCE** - faculty involvement in institutional AI decisions (adoption, expectations, policy, PD priorities); shared governance; transparency in decision-making

- **PERSPECTIVE SHIFT** - changed assumptions, redesigned assessments, reframed AI role, and reflective change indicators
- **TRANSFORMATIVE CONDITIONS** - coaching, community, hands-on application, discipline-specific supports, iterative learning structures

F. "What Faculty Want" (Design Requirements)

- **BITE SIZED SERIES** - modular, repeatable learning series across the year
- **SANDBOX LAB** - safe space, access to pro tools; experimentation without risk
- **INCENTIVES STIPENDS** - compensation/recognition/microcredentials; workload acknowledgment
- **CLEAR POLICY GUIDANCE** - unified policy, ethical guidelines, classroom models, clarity on acceptable use

Why this works: It is grounded in your conceptual framework without forcing the data to behave, and it cleanly captures the full range from enthusiastic adoption to strongly skeptical, emotionally charged narratives.

3) SECOND-CYCLE THEMES

What is emerging already (dissertation-friendly titles)

Theme 1: AI-PD sits on a fault line between compliance infrastructure and professional growth.

Faculty repeatedly contrast "checkbox" trainings with applied, reflective learning.

Theme 2: Engagement is shaped less by attitude and more by conditions.

Time, workload, clarity, access, and support explain participation better than pro/anti-AI dispositions.

Theme 3: Faculty orient toward AI in two functional ways builders and policers.

Builders use AI for instructional capacity; policers center integrity and assessment control. Both reflect legitimate responsibilities.

Theme 4: Human-centered teaching is a boundary line, not a slogan.

AI is welcomed when it supports accessibility and student care and resisted when it dehumanizes, standardizes, or undermines professional voice.

Theme 5: Ethics operates as trust and institutional intent, not abstract philosophy.

Privacy, bias, transparency, and surveillance concerns function as prerequisites for engagement.

Theme 6: Faculty-defined "good AI-PD" is co-designed, supported, disciplined-informed, and iterative.

Faculty consistently call for stipends, licenses, sandboxing, modular series, peer learning, clear policy and meaningful faculty voice in AI decision-making.

4) Mapping to Research Questions (RQ alignment in words)

- **RQ1 (experiences + transformation):** Themes 1 and 6 (with indicators in Themes 2/4)
- **RQ2 (misconceptions/knowledge gaps):** Themes 3 and 5 (AI = cheating only; AI = replacement narrative; "AI is predictable/plagiarism. ")
- **RQ3 (attitudes/resistance):** Themes 2 and 5 (and Theme 1 as framing driver)
- **RQ4 (teaching & students):** Theme 3 (builder impacts) & Theme 4 (student-centered boundary conditions)
- **RQ5 (human-centered values):** Theme 4
- **RQ6 (confidence/supports):** Theme 2 & Theme 6

- **RQ7 (ethics):** Theme 5
- **RQ8 (agency/autonomy):** Theme 6 (and Theme 1's mandate tension)
- **RQ9 (institutional implications):** Theme 6 & Theme 5 (governance, trust, investment)

APPENDIX H

IRB EXEMPTION LETTER

Institutional Review Board

TO: Reyna Trujillo

FROM: La Verne Institutional Review Board

RE: **2025-82-LFCE, FROM COMPLIANCE TO TRANSFORMATION: FACULTY PERSPECTIVES ON AI-DRIVEN PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT**

The research project application for exemption, cited above, was reviewed by the University of La Verne (La Verne) Institutional Review Board (IRB). Congratulations, your La Verne IRB application has been **determined to be exempt** and you can proceed with the proposed study.

A copy of this letter is required to be included as an appendix to your completed thesis/dissertation. An exempt determination means there is no expiration date, but you need to keep the IRB apprised of your progress through annual activity reports.

Consent and recruitment documents are not required to be uploaded and reviewed for exempt studies. However, researchers are reminded that University of La Verne follows the principles of the Belmont Report, which requires all potential participants to be informed of the research study, their rights as a participant, confidentiality of their data, etc. It is recommended you utilize the Information Sheet for exempt research (https://laverne.edu/irb/irb-forms-and-examples/informed-consent-forms-templates/) and revise the template to be specific to your study. This document will not be reviewed by the IRB. It is the responsibility of the researcher to make sure the document is consistent with the study procedures listed in the application.

Please note the following conditions apply to all exempt IRB submissions:

The IRB expects to receive prompt notice of any proposed changes as per the guidelines in the modification policy document: https://laverne.edu/irb/wp-content/uploads/sites/28/2018/08/La-Verne-IRB-Modifications-amended-new-regs.pdf

Changes to your protocol will require a new determination, which may not be exempt.

Notification that you have completed the data collection for the study and/or annual reports indicating your study is still active.

The IRB wishes to extend to you its best wishes for a successful research endeavor.

Christine Jagannathan	Christine Jagannathan, Ed.D.	11/14/2025
Approval Signature	IRB Director/Chair	Date

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